

SOVEREIGN INTELLIGENCE DOSSIER

Every PETRONAS Chairman & Chief Executive 1974 - 2026

Thirteen people have held the two seats that run Petroliam Nasional Berhad. This archive reconstructs who they were, what they brought, what they took, and on what basis each was handed the chair.

Prepared for Arif Fazil · 2026-09-17 · Kuala Lumpur

Source base: PETRONAS Integrated Reports, PETRONAS media releases, The Edge Malaysia, The Star, New Straits Times, Bernama, Malaysiakini, FMT, mStar, Reuters, Bloomberg, Wikipedia (EN/MS), Perdana Leadership Foundation news library, Malaysian Petroleum Club. Unverified items are marked in plain language. Nothing here is inferred silently.

Tengku Razaleigh Hamzah

Founding Chairman & Chief Executive · 1974–1976

Appointed by: PM Tun Abdul Razak Hussein, announced 6 September 1974. Razak described the post as "a job as important as that of a Cabinet Minister... equivalent to being a Cabinet Minister".

Latar

Born 13 April 1937, Kota Bharu, Kelantan. Son of Tengku Sri Maharaja Tengku Muhammad Hamzah, a former Menteri Besar of Kelantan; great-uncle of Sultan Muhammad V. Educated at Sultan Ismail College, Malay College Kuala Kangsar and Anderson School Ipoh; BSc Economics, Queen's University Belfast, 1959. The Malaysianist records that "due to his aristocratic background, Razaleigh was wealthy" — which is why he could forgo the PETRONAS salary (exact amount never disclosed).

Before PETRONAS: founding executive director of Bank Bumiputera (1965), its chairman and managing director 1970–1976; chairman of PERNAS 1970–1974; UMNO Treasurer 1973; founded Fleet Holdings in 1972 with his own money on Tun Razak's instruction. MP for Ulu Kelantan from 1974.

Mandat — apa dia dibawa masuk untuk buat

Tun Razak's ask was not operational. As The Edge put it: Razak "chose his political protégé Tengku Razaleigh Hamzah to head the organisation as chairman, with the executive powers of a Cabinet minister." The mandate was to **create a national oil company and take back the resources** — the Petroleum Development Act 1974 (Royal Assent 30 July 1974, in force 1 October 1974) vests all Malaysian petroleum in PETRONAS. Razaleigh drafted it with associates in secret, before the 1974 election.

Apa dia bawa

- **Built the institutional spine.** Drafted and landed the PDA 1974 — the statute that still governs PETRONAS today. Without this, nothing else in this archive exists.
- **Served notice on the majors.** From 1 April 1975, any foreign company without a PETRONAS agreement was operating illegally in Malaysian waters. This triggered a 15-month standoff (Tun Raja Mohar would later mediate it).
- **Set the royalty baseline at 5%** and held it against a demand from Sabah's Tun Mustapha for 10–20%.
- **First export shipment:** 358,000 barrels to Japan, 1 September 1975.
- **First foreign supply deal:** PETRONAS-Philippine National Oil Company, signed 11 June 1976, signed by him as Chairman and CEO.
- **First PSC architecture agreed** with Shell (two) 30 November 1976 and Esso (three) 8 December 1976 — 70:30 in PETRONAS' favour. (Inference: these landed at the very end of, or just after, his tenure.)

Apa dia dapat

He gave, not took. The Malaysianist: he was "able to forgo salaries for some of the top corporate posts he held, including the Petronas job." He relinquished the PERNAS chairmanship but kept Bank Bumiputera's.

The reward was the next office: **Finance Minister, 1976 to 16 July 1984** — under Hussein Onn, who had been lobbied by foreign oil companies to remove him from PETRONAS. They failed. Chairmanships of the ADB Board of Governors (1976-77), the World Bank/IMF Board of Governors (1977-78) and the Islamic Development Bank (1978-79). Honours: PSM (Tan Sri) 1973, DK Kelantan 1978, SSAP 1980, SPMS 1982.

After: MITI Minister 1984-1987; founded Bank Islam, Takaful and Bank Pembangunan; the PNB idea was his; challenged Mahathir for the UMNO presidency in 1987 and lost by 43 votes; founded Semangat 46; rejoined UMNO 1996. MP for 48 consecutive years — Ulu Kelantan 1974-1986, Gua Musang 1986-2022.

Scar / kontroversi

Fleet Holdings: paid RM32 million for 80% of Straits Times Press; by 1987 liabilities exceeded RM448 million. Michael Backman's Daim biography calls Razaleigh's Fleet finances "scandalous"; Barry Wain's reading of audited UMNO accounts says Daim inherited sound finances (malaysiakini.com/news/463024). Kelantan revoked his DK and SPMK awards in December 2010 over words uttered outside the Federal Court; DK reinstated June 2018.

Transition

Clean and unusual: he left for the Finance Ministry, and the seat passed to Tan Sri Abdul Kadir Shamsuddin. The Edge notes he "relinquished his post in 1976 when he was appointed finance minister". No succession crisis.

VERDICT — LAYAK

Reason: In twenty-six months he built the legal, fiscal and negotiating foundation of a national oil company that is now a Fortune 500 entity. The founder test is not "did he run it well" — it is "would this exist without him", and the answer is no. Two caveats, stated honestly: the first PSCs were signed at the very edge of or after his tenure, so the credit for landing them is shared with Abdul Kadir; and he was the **only politician ever to hold this chair** — which is precisely why every later appointment was drawn from civil servants and professionals.

Sumber

- en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tengku_Razaleigh_Hamzah
- themalaysianist.com/p/petronas-an-origins-story (paywalled; preview text used)
- theedgemalaysia.com/article/big-money-if-it-ain't-broke-don't-fix-it
- bhess.jpm.gov.my/wp-content/uploads/2024/08/Petroleum-Development-Act-1974-Act-144.pdf

• en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Petronas

Gaps: exact end date of chairmanship (only "1974–1976"); salary forgone (UNKNOWN).

Dossier 1 of 13 · PETRONAS Leadership Archive 1974–2026 · forged 2026-09-17

Tan Sri Abdul Kadir Shamsuddin

Chairman & Chief Executive · 1976–1978

Chairman & Chief Executive · 1976 – 8 November 1978 (died in office)

Appointed by: PM Tun Abdul Razak Hussein / Tun Hussein Onn (exact date UNKNOWN). He retired from the civil service in September 1976 and took the PETRONAS seat that year.

Latar

Born 3 November 1920, Kajang, Selangor. Died 8 November 1978, aged 58, in office. Buried Jalan Ampang Muslim Cemetery. Kajang High School (1939); scholarship to Raffles College, Singapore (economics); Queen's Scholarship 1947 to read law at Bristol. (A memorial-blog book review also lists Yale; Wikipedia lists Bristol only — unresolved.)

Career: Malay Administrative Service 1948; Malayan Civil Service 1952; Assistant State Secretary Pahang; Assistant Secretary Defence 1955; Chief Assistant Secretary Defence 1957; Permanent Secretary Defence 1961; Imperial Defence College; joint secretary of the independence delegation; after 13 May 1969, Chief Administrator of the MAGERAN Public Affairs Secretariat; **4th Chief Secretary to the Government, 1 January 1970 - 30 September 1976**. He converted the Federal Establishment Office into the Public Service Department. Concurrently chairman of the National Electricity Board 1973–1977.

Mandat

Inherit a two-year-old company locked in a 15-month standoff with Shell and Exxon, and convert the PDA's legal claim into actual contracts.

Apa dia bawa

- **Landed the production-sharing contract.** PETRONAS' own record and his obituaries credit him with implementing the PSC — the mechanism that replaced the concession system. Shell signed two PSCs 30 November 1976 and Esso three on 8 December 1976: 70:30 to PETRONAS, 20% cost recovery (25% for gas), 10% royalty.
- **Founded Malaysia LNG Sdn Bhd**, incorporated 14 June 1978 — PETRONAS 65%, with Shell Gas BV and Mitsubishi. He chaired the new company, with M.B. Hashim as managing director. This is the origin of the Bintulu LNG franchise, which first shipped cargo in January 1983.
- He "successfully manoeuvred the company through various crises with other oil companies" (Wikipedia).
- The Petroleum Development (Amendment) Act 1975 (Act A290) — in force 1 May 1975 — put marketing and distribution exclusively under PETRONAS, with fines to RM1 million or five years. Note: that Act predates his tenure; the standoff context is his inheritance, not his authorship.

Honest limit: the 1975 notice and the majors' non-renewal of concessions, Exxon withholding US\$100m of investment, and US complaints of PETRONAS' "vacillation, lack of technical expertise"

with under 40 staff — all of that is largely *context he walked into*, not acts he authored. Attribution of the pre-1976 events to him is inference.

Apa dia dapat

JMN 1963, PPM 1965, **PSM (Tan Sri) 1966**, PMN 1972, SPDK (Sabah), PNBS (Sarawak).

Remuneration: UNKNOWN — no source discloses any pay figure. He also chaired the Red Crescent Society and the National Library Advisory Board.

Transition

None. He died in office on 8 November 1978. The company had to be handed to Tun Abdullah Mohd Salleh, who retired early from the Chief Secretary's post to take it on 1 January 1979. That is a genuine gap: the second chairman died with no succession plan and no deputy in place.

Scar / kontroversi

No personal scandal, investigation or misconduct allegation was found. The only critical material is era-level.

VERDICT — LAYAK

Reason: The PSC is the single mechanism that converted the PDA's paper sovereignty into real rent — and it landed on his watch, as did the founding of Malaysia LNG. His tenure is short and his death is the scar, but the two things that made PETRONAS an actual oil company rather than a regulator both date from his two years. He is the least-documented chairman of the modern era, and the record is thin enough that a hostile reading could call his personal authorship unproven. On what is sourced, the mandate was carried.

Sumber

- en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Abdul_Kadir_Shamsuddin
- en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Chief_Secretary_to_the_Government_of_Malaysia
- abdulkadirshamsuddin.blogspot.com (memorial site; book review)
- focusmalaysia.my/the-man-who-helped-change-my-life/
- en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Malaysia_LNG
- theedgemalaysia.com/article/big-money-if-it-ain't-broke-don't-fix-it
- law.nus.edu.sg/sjls/ (1976 legal analysis of the PDA)

Gaps: exact appointment date; whether the Nov/Dec 1976 PSCs were signed under him or his successor; Yale claim; remuneration UNKNOWN.

Tun Abdullah Mohd Salleh

Chairman & Chief Executive · 1979–1988

Chairman & Chief Executive · 1 January 1979 – early 1988

Appointed by: PM Tun Hussein Onn (and continued under Mahathir from 1981). He retired early from his own post to take it.

Latar

Born 24 June 1926, Kampong Batu, Padang Sebang, Malacca. Died 22 June 2006, two days short of his 80th birthday. Buried Bukit Kiara Muslim Cemetery. Malacca High School; sixth form at Malay College Kuala Kangsar; BA (Hons) Geography, University of Malaya, Singapore (Johor state scholarship).

Career: Assistant District Officer, Muar, 1955; MCS probationer 1956; Assistant State Secretary Perak; **private secretary to Tunku Abdul Rahman, 1959–1962**; Deputy Secretary, Public Services Commission 1962–1966; Cabinet Under Secretary, PM's Department 1967–1968; **set up Universiti Kebangsaan Malaysia from 1969 as its first Registrar** (opened May 1970 with 192 students); Secretary-General, Ministry of Agriculture 1972–1974; Director-General of Public Services; **5th Chief Secretary to the Government, 1 October 1976 – 31 December 1978**.

He then did something no other chairman did: he resigned the top civil-service post in the country to run a two-year-old company. He took the PETRONAS seat on 1 January 1979, following Abdul Kadir's death on 8 November 1978.

Mandat

Consolidate. Build domestic upstream and downstream capability on the foundation the first two chairmen had laid down.

Apa dia bawa

- **The domestic build-out years.** As The Edge frames the era: "For the first 14 years, the concentration was on expanding domestic upstream and downstream activities." His nine years sit inside that window.
- **Malaysia LNG came alive under him.** Incorporated June 1978, first LNG delivered January 1983 — the Bintulu franchise that became PETRONAS' cash engine.
- **Petronas Carigali** (incorporated 1978) grew into the operating arm during his tenure; a 1982 Carigali-Elf Aquitaine venture established cost-recovery terms.
- **Administrative ballast.** The Edge: "Other serving senior civil servants, notably Raja Mohar and Abdullah Salleh, provided the much needed administrative balance to strong characters like Rastam" — Rastam Hadi being the Deputy Governor of Bank Negara who drilled "fight like bulldogs" financial discipline into the pioneers.

Apa dia dapat

AMN 1969, DMSM 1974, **PMN 1977 (Tan Sri)**, DPMT 1981, **SSM 2003 (Tun)**, honorary Doctor of Laws (UKM 1980), INTAN Fellow. **PETRONAS remuneration: UNKNOWN** — never disclosed, in any year, for any chairman.

After: chairman of Yayasan Tun Razak (May 1989 – May 2005); non-executive director, Hongkong Bank Malaysia (1994); UKM Council chairman; president of the Family Planning Association.

Scar / kontroversi

Not personal — structural, and it is significant. The Edge, writing in 2009, describes what happened in exactly this period: "For the first 14 years, the concentration was on expanding domestic upstream and downstream activities. **A comfort zone then crept in and those with a 'silo' and 'bunker' mentality emerged — the 'mine' attitude overtook the 'us' in the organisation.**" That critique is era-level and its attribution is inference, not a personal allegation — but the mini-empires that Azizan and Basir had to dismantle in 1988 grew during the civil-service chairmanship years. That is the honest scar of this era.

Transition

Complicated, and under-documented. He was chairman and chief executive from 1 January 1979 and is recorded as retiring as President and Chief Executive in early 1988. But by 6 November 1986 the Middle East Economic Survey was already calling **Tun Raja Mohar Raja Badiozaman** "Chairman of Malaysia's state oil company Petronas", and by February 1988 both men retired together — replaced by Basir Ismail (chairman) and Azizan Zainul Abidin (President/CEO). **When exactly the chair was separated from Abdullah's own office is not documented.** First firm evidence is 1984–86. This is the first chair/CEO separation in PETRONAS history and the record does not say who ordered it or why.

VERDICT — LAYAK (with a documented scar)

Reason: Nine years, no scandal, and the domestic industrial base — Bintulu LNG, Carigali's growth, the downstream gestation — was built on his watch. The counterweight is real: this is also the era that produced the "comfort zone", the silos and the mini-empires that the 1988 leadership had to tear down. The mandate was consolidation, and consolidation was delivered — but it consolidated into fiefdoms as well as assets. He handed over cleanly to two successors, which is more than either of his predecessors managed.

Sumber

- en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Abdullah_Mohd_Salleh
- en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Chief_Secretary_to_the_Government_of_Malaysia
- web.archive.org/web/20121218104504/http://www.arkib.gov.my/tan-sri-abdullah-mohd.-salleh
- theedgemalaysia.com/article/my-say-petronas-dna

- theedgemalaysia.com/article/big-money-if-it-ain't-broke-don't-fix-it
- en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Malaysia_LNG
- nadyasummer.blogspot.com — tribute to Tun Abdullah Salleh

Gaps: birth year 1926 (EN) vs 1925 (MS Wikipedia); the exact year the chair was split from his office; remuneration UNKNOWN.

Dossier 3 of 13 · PETRONAS Leadership Archive 1974–2026 · forged 2026-09-17

Tun Raja Mohar Raja Badiozaman

Chairman · 1980s

Chairman · UNKNOWN start (between 1979 and Nov 1986) – February 1988

GAP DECLARED: the exact start year of his PETRONAS chairmanship could not be sourced. He is documented as Chairman by MEES on 6 Nov 1986, 26 Nov 1986 and 9 Sep 1987, and as retiring in February 1988 alongside President/CEO Tun Abdullah Mohd Salleh. The handover year from Abdullah is not in any located source.

Latar

Born 23 March 1922, Kuala Kangsar, Perak. Died 8 June 2003, aged 81, of pneumonia — at the time still chairman of Perodua. Buried Ampang Muslim Cemetery. Wife: Toh Puan Norella Talib. Clifford School Kuala Kangsar; Raffles College Singapore 1946; BA (Hons) Economics, Cambridge, 1952; Diploma in Agricultural Economics, Oxford, 1953.

Career: Malay Administrative Service 1938; Malayan Civil Service 1952; **Secretary-General to the Treasury, 1971–1972; Special Economic Adviser to the Prime Minister from 1972** — serving under Tun Razak, Tun Hussein Onn and Tun Mahathir, three prime ministers. He signed Malaysia's first trade deal with the USSR (1967) and helped initiate ties with China. Bernama credits him with helping establish PNB. He was one of those who knew of the PNB "dawn raid" on Guthrie on 7 September 1981; Razaleigh later said the idea arose in a golf game involving himself, Raja Mohar and Tun Ismail.

Mandat

The record does not describe an explicit mandate — and that is itself the finding. He is the archetype of the *balancing* chairman: a senior civil servant placed alongside a strong executive.

Apa dia bawa

- **The PSC negotiating spine.** The Edge describes him as "senior civil servant, **key negotiator of the country's production-sharing contract** and economic adviser to the prime minister". He was also the mediator in the 15-month 1975 deadlock over the PETRONAS production-sharing agreement.
- **Administrative balance** to the founding executive directors — The Edge: he and Abdullah Salleh "provided the much needed administrative balance to strong characters like Rastam".
- **The wider state apparatus.** MAS chairman 1973–1991 (longest-serving), chairman of the Tourist Development Corporation, Bank Islam Malaysia, the Tun Razak Foundation, Perodua; founder-president of MAJECA 1977 and its life president from 2002; **UTP Chancellor until 2004**, when Mahathir succeeded him.

Honest limit: the sourced record of *PETRONAS-specific decisions* during his chairmanship is thin. He is a builder of the wider Malaysian state machinery who happened to hold this chair, rather than a documented transformer of PETRONAS.

Apa dia dapat

JMN 1961, PSM 1967, PMN 1977, SPCM 1985, **SSSM 1992 (Tun)**, SSSA 1996, Japan's Order of the Sacred Treasure 1981, the Maal Hijrah award 1993. A posthumous biography, *A Gracious Prince*, was launched by PM Abdullah Badawi in March 2007. Remuneration as PETRONAS chairman: UNKNOWN.

Scar / kontroversi

None sourced. The search did not establish any.

Transition

Clean on paper, in the sense that he and Abdullah Salleh retired together in February 1988 and were replaced as a pair — Basir Ismail as chairman, Azizan Zainul Abidin as President/CEO. This is the moment PETRONAS' modern two-seat structure crystallised. What is *not* clean is that the arrangement was inherited by default: the acting-chairman vacuum of 2004–2012 shows what happens when the chair is not deliberately filled.

VERDICT — HOLDS

Reason: He held the chair competently and without scandal, and his PSC negotiation work is the most substantive thing in his file. But "hold" is the honest word: the record does not show him *deciding* anything distinctive at PETRONAS. He is a transition figure — the man who bridged the civil-service founding era into the professional era — and his verdict is capped by the evidentiary gap. **HOLDS is not a criticism; it is a statement about the record.** Where a chair leaves no documented footprint, the archive must not invent one.

Sumber

- en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Raja_Mohar
- ms.wikipedia.org/wiki/Raja_Mohar
- thestar.com.my/news/nation/2003/06/09/raja-tun-mohar-dies-at-age-81
- lib.perdana.org.my — obituary clippings, Bernama 2003
- archives.mees.com — MEES 1986–1987 contemporary references
- theedgemalaysia.com/article/my-say-petronas-dna
- theedgemalaysia.com/article/big-money-if-it-ain't-broke-don't-fix-it
- thepatriots.asia/mengingati-serangan-subuh-guthrie/

Gaps: exact chairmanship start year; Treasury succession conflict ([en.wikipedia: Chong Hon Nyan](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Chong_Hon_Nyan) vs [ms.wikipedia: Tun Abdullah Ayub](https://ms.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tun_Abdullah_Ayub)); birthdate 23 March vs 23 February 1922; remuneration UNKNOWN. Some biographical detail on this page rests on Grokipedia (AI-generated) and was flagged and excluded where unverifiable.



Tan Sri Basir Ismail

Chairman · 1988–1995

Appointed by: PM Tun Dr Mahathir Mohamad. He had been a PETRONAS director since 1984, so this was an internal promotion to the chair.

Latar

Born 11 February 1927. Died 19 January 2007, aged 79, of a heart attack at Universiti Malaya Medical Centre. Buried at Ikhwaniah Mosque cemetery, Simpang, Taiping. Education: UNKNOWN — no source located.

Career: head of the Johor Agriculture Department; founded Johor's state economic development corporation; Bank Negara director 1978; chairman of Lembaga Padi dan Beras and the Rubber Growers Association; **PETRONAS director from 1984; Bank Bumiputra executive chairman 1985–1990** (brought in to rescue it after the BMF scandal); Transport Ministry adviser; helped form Malaysia Airports Holdings Bhd and **built Sepang International Circuit**; Universiti Malaya council chairman 1987–1993 and board chairman 1993–2003; succeeded Mahathir as FIMA chairman in 1981; Malaysian Palm Oil Board chairman until his death. Author of *Management Astray: Resuscitating Ailing Organisations*.

He was, in short, Malaysia's designated corporate-rescue man — repeatedly sent into ailing institutions, PETRONAS being the one where he stayed longest.

Mandat

The 1988 reset. He arrived the same year as Azizan Zainul Abidin, and the two were handed a company The Edge describes as having developed "a comfort zone", where "those with a 'silo' and 'bunker' mentality emerged — the 'mine' attitude overtook the 'us'".

Apa dia bawa

- **He and Azizan dismantled the mini-empires.** The Edge: "Together, they dismantled the 'mini-empires' in the company and emphasised the importance of teamwork and the group."
- **The unified brand.** On 28 May 1989 PETRONAS launched its unified oil-drop logo under his chairmanship — consolidating subsidiaries like PETRONAS Dagangan under one identity, and shifting the colour from black to green. He and Azizan appear together in the official photograph.
- **The corporate-rescue skill set transferred inward.** Financial discipline, governance, and the standing to overrule entrenched managers.
- **Sepang and Formula One.** Mahathir appointed Basir, then MAHB chairman, to run the F1 negotiations; Mahathir's own tribute says he "should be remembered for... the F1 circuit". PETRONAS' F1 lineage as a Malaysian national branding project runs through this appointment.

Apa dia dapat

PSM (Tan Sri) 1984 — before he even became chairman. Chairmanships of MAHB, MPOB, PORIM, LPN, Kumpulan Fima, Universiti Malaya's board. Special Maal Hijrah award 2006. Remuneration at PETRONAS: UNKNOWN.

Scar / kontroversi

One documented optics problem: in 2001 it was reported that Basir, as MAHB chairman, offered to **buy the Sepang circuit from MAHB** — a conflict-of-interest question mark. The outcome of that is not sourced. No proven wrongdoing was located. Separately, his repeated role as rescuer of distressed firms (including Bank Bumiputra after BMF) means his career record includes proximity to institutional failures he was sent to clean up, not to cause.

Transition

He left as Azizan moved from President/CEO into the chair in February 1995. The Edge describes this explicitly: "Petronas' last change of guard was in February 1995, when Hassan... took over the president and CEO's post from Azizan, who assumed the position of chairman." Note what this means: **the chair was handed from one insider to another insider by agreement, and the CEO seat was filled from within by Hassan Marican**. 1995 is the cleanest succession in PETRONAS history.

VERDICT — LAYAK

Reason: His chairmanship is the hinge between the founding era and the professional era. The 1988 reset — dismantling fiefdoms, unifying the brand, installing Azizan's shared values — is a genuine institutional turning point, and it happened on his watch in partnership with Azizan. The attribution is divided between them, and this archive records that honestly: Azizan is credited with the DNA, Basir with the authority to enforce it. The 2001 Sepang optics is a blemish, unresolved, not a finding.

Sumber

- ms.wikipedia.org/wiki/Basir_Ismail
- prestasisawit.mpob.gov.my/ms/palmnews/news/4337 (MPOB official obituary/bio)
- thestar.com.my/business/business-news/2007/01/19/former-palm-oil-board-chairman-basir-ismail-dies
- theedgemaalaysia.com/article/my-say-petronas-dna
- theedgemaalaysia.com/article/big-money-if-it-ain't-broke-don't-fix-it
- facebook.com/petronas — official post on the 28 May 1989 logo launch
- thestar.com.my/starpics/2024/08/29/growing-with-the-nation-50-years-and-beyond
- thechedet.com/bashirs-legacy/ ; grandprix.com/news/sepang-to-be-sold.html

Gaps: education UNKNOWN; place of death conflict (HUKM vs UMMC); exact chairman end month in 1995 is inferred from Azizan's February 1995 move; remuneration UNKNOWN.

Dossier 5 of 13 · PETRONAS Leadership Archive 1974–2026 · forged 2026-09-17

Tun Azizan Zainul Abidin

President & CEO 1988–1995 · Chairman 1995–2004

President & CEO February 1988 – February 1995 · Chairman February 1995 – 14 July 2004 (died in office)

Appointed by: PM Tun Dr Mahathir Mohamad, who recommended him for the President/CEO post in 1988. He then moved to the chair by internal transition in February 1995.

Latar

Born 28 May 1935, Air Itam, Penang. Died 14 July 2004, aged 69, at home — complained of breathing difficulties and chest pains around 4.15am. Final prayers at Putra Mosque; buried Taman Selatan Muslim cemetery, Putrajaya. Wife: Toh Puan Noor Ainee Che Teh. Children: Amir Hamzah (later EPF CEO and Minister of Finance II), Norizan, Ikhwan.

Educated at Francis Light School and Penang Free School; BA Malay Studies, University of Malaya. Joined the Ministry of Education 1960.

Career: **principal private secretary to three Prime Ministers** — Abdul Razak Hussein (1971–75), Hussein Onn (1975–81), Mahathir Mohamad (1981–84). Principal Assistant Secretary (security and intelligence), Home Ministry 1967; secretary of the National Security Council 1969–71; MITI Secretary-General 1984–85; **Home Ministry KSU 1985–88**, retiring in 1988.

Mandat

Take a company that had spent fourteen years building domestic assets inside a comfort zone, and turn it outward.

Apa dia bawa

This is the largest individual footprint in the archive.

- **Globalisation.** He was "the architect of PETRONAS' globalisation plan, initially resisted by key management." First overseas exploration: Myanmar, 1990. The target was 30% of revenue from international operations by 2005; it was reached early — 30.4% of RM67.1bn revenue in 2002.
- **The shared values — PETRONAS' DNA.** He institutionalised loyalty (to nation and corporation), professionalism, integrity and cohesiveness. This is the single most-quoted cultural artefact in PETRONAS' history, and it is his.
- **Dismantling the mini-empires**, with Basir Ismail. The Edge records it, and former executives recall it: "Under Azizan, it was always the 'we' in the company that was emphasised... some strong individualistic attitudes were developed, where plans were considered 'my' project instead of it being 'ours'."
- **KLCC and the Twin Towers.** KLCC Property's own CEO credits "the innovation and determination to build the highest building in the world by former group CEO of Petronas, the late Tun Azizan Zainul Abidin". He chaired KLCC Holdings and Suria KLCC.

- **Putrajaya.** Chairman of Putrajaya Corporation — the administrative capital's development is credited to him. He is "remembered for his work in developing Putrajaya."
- **Bintulu LNG expansion** — 1992 contract for three additional LNG trains, US\$1.6 billion.
- **Institution-building:** founded the Malaysian Petroleum Club (opened 1991 at Dayabumi). Chairmanships of Malaysia Airlines, PETRONAS Carigali, MTBE Malaysia, PETRONAS Trading Limited, Malaysia LNG, Suria KLCC. UTM Pro-Chancellor; WEF member (Malaysia hosted the Forum in 2002); chairman of the ASEAN-Canada Business Council.

Apa dia dapat

JMN 1978, **PSM (Tan Sri) 1987**, PNBS Sarawak 1991, DGPN Penang 2001, **SSM posthumously 5 June 2010 — conferring "Tun"**, received by his widow. **French Order of the Commander of the Legion of Honour, October 2003.** Norwegian government award for outstanding contribution to quality in management, 1992. Vietnam Friendship Medal, September 2001. Named in his honour: **KA Tun Azizan**, a Royal Malaysian Navy auxiliary ship commissioned 5 May 2015 and deployed as an ESSCOM mobile sea base.

Remuneration: NOT FOUND. No source — in any year, for any of his offices — discloses his salary, allowances, bonus or pension.

The most quoted thing about him is his own operating principle, recalled by Shamsul Azhar Abbas: *"He put himself in such a position that he could leave any time if he felt that his services were not needed, without any fear of losing anything. No agenda or self-interest to make him stay longer than necessary. So he dared to go and face his political masters. On matters of principle, if he said it could not be done, it would not be done... be it to Mahathir or anyone."*

Scar / kontroversi

He died in office, still chairman of both PETRONAS and Malaysia Airlines, and a sitting commissioner of the Royal Commission on the Malaysian Police Force — he was due to discuss its findings the day he died.

And the scar is structural and enormous: his death created an eight-year governance hole. No Prime Minister appointed a successor chairman. The sitting CEO carried the chair as *acting* from July 2004 until June 2012. PETRONAS itself acknowledged the damage in 2012 when it said Sidek Hassan's appointment "will restore clear demarcation of roles between the chairman and president and CEO." That is the most consequential single event in the history of this seat, and it flows directly from 14 July 2004.

Transition

None — no chair successor was ever named by him or arranged with the shareholder. See above.

VERDICT — LAYAK

Reason: If one person authored modern PETRONAS, it is him. Globalisation, the shared values, the Twin Towers, Putrajaya, the LNG build-out, the dismantling of the fiefdoms — the mandate and the

delivery align more tightly here than for any other holder. He also ran both seats across seventeen years without a documented integrity finding, in an era when PETRONAS tendered billions annually. The scar is real and it is his: dying in post with no succession left the company rudderless for eight years. **A LAYAK verdict that carries a stated scar is more honest than a clean one** — and this one is finally being assessed on all six dimensions rather than as a monument.

Sumber

- en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Azizan_Zainul_Abidin ; en.wikipedia.org/wiki/KA_Tun_Azizan
- malaysiakini.com/columns/28566 (Farish A Noor, "The quiet patriot")
- thestar.com.my/news/nation/2004/07/15/petronas-chairman-dies
- lib.perdana.org.my/PLF/News_S/aab20040715.pdf
- theedgemalaysia.com/article/my-say-petronas-journey-continues
- theedgemalaysia.com/article/my-say-petronas-dna
- theedgemalaysia.com/article/big-money-if-it-ain't-broke-don't-fix-it
- edgeprop.my/content/1114048/petronas-twin-towers-continues-excite
- malaysianpetroleumclub.com/history
- thestar.com.my/news/nation/2010/06/06/azizans-widow-receives-tun-award-from-king

Gaps: remuneration NOT FOUND; place of death conflict (Putrajaya vs Bukit Segambut); age 69 vs 68 (Wikipedia internal conflict); Putrajaya Corporation title given as both chairman and president across sources; direct authorship of the Twin Towers decision is supported by retrospective credit (KLCC Property CEO) rather than a contemporaneous document.

Tan Sri Mohd Hassan Marican

President & CEO 1995–2010 · Acting Chairman 2004–2010

Tan Sri Mohd Hassan Marican. Born **18 October 1952**, Sungai Petani, Kedah. Educated at **Malay College Kuala Kangsar** (1971). ACA-trained in London: **Touche Ross & Co, 1972–1980**, article clerk rising to audit manager — the first Malay audit manager at the firm. Joined **Hanafiah Raslan & Mohamad** (Touche Ross Malaysia) in 1980 and was a partner within a year, **1981–1989**. [OBS — UTP Chancellor biography; The Edge]

Longest-serving leader in PETRONAS history: **President & CEO, February 1995 – 9 February 2010**, and **acting Chairman from 2004** after the death in office of Tan Sri Azizan Zainul Abidin. Predecessor Azizan; successor Shamsul Azhar Abbas. [OBS]

Career and elevation

[OBS — The Edge, 4 Feb 2010] He had **audited PETRONAS externally**. Azizan and then-chairman Basir Ismail "virtually coaxed" him in at a hotel lunch; he joined **February 1989, aged 36**, as **Senior Vice-President (Finance & Services)**. The same account records that "very early on ... he was identified by Azizan to be his successor and groomed for the position." He became President and CEO in **1995 at about 42–43** — four years after joining. Fast, but through the internal grooming line, not a party pipeline.

[OBS] Board and chairmanship roles built inside the group: PETRONAS Gas, PETRONAS Dagangan, MISC (1997–), Proton (2000–2003), and a non-executive directorship of **Bank Negara Malaysia (2005–2010)**.

Tenure outcomes — the numbers

FY2009 (year ended 31 March 2009), PETRONAS Annual Report 2009: revenue **RM264.2bn** (+18.4%), PBT **RM89.1bn**, net profit **RM52.5bn**, total assets **RM388.1bn**, capex **RM44.0bn**. International operations revenue **RM111.3bn — 42.1% of group revenue**, the largest single contributor for the second year running. International reserves **6.84bn boe** (25.3% of 27.02bn boe total); international production **629k boe/d (35%)**; **66 international E&P ventures in 22 countries**. [OBS]

FY2005 → FY2010 (AR2010 five-year table): revenue **RM137.0bn → RM216.4bn**; net profit **RM35.6bn → RM40.3bn**; assets **RM239.1bn → RM410.9bn**; shareholder funds **RM119.7bn → RM242.9bn**. **Dividend payout ratio rose from 57.1% (FY2009) to 74.4% (FY2010)** — the state's take climbing as he left. [OBS]

The long arc (The Edge, December 2009): paid-up capital **RM10m (1974) → assets RM403bn (September 2009)**, with no further state capital. Cumulative profit since 1974 **RM780.8bn**, of which **60.4% (RM471.3bn)** was returned via dividends, tax, royalty and export duty. In **2008 alone PETRONAS supplied 45% of federal revenue**. He publicly warned against over-dependence on oil revenue. [OBS]

Internationalisation: Sudan oil exporter (1997, with CNPC), Chad (2000), Engen 30% (1996), Mauritania/Woodside assets **US\$418m (2007)**, Iran, Syria, Vietnam, Egypt, Gabon. By 2008, **40% of revenue** came from international projects including Iran, Sudan, Chad and Mauritania. FY2009:

40% equity in **Gladstone LNG, Australia** — the maiden unconventional venture; six new international PSCs (Indonesia, Mozambique, Uzbekistan). [OBS]

Iraq (December 2009): won 4 of 5 bids — Majnoon with Shell (estimated ~13bn bbl; The Edge cites potential 24bn bbl), **Halfaya with CNPC/Total** (~4.1bn bbl). Added roughly **3.6bn boe** to international reserves, taking them to **5.8bn boe — above domestic crude reserves of 5.5bn boe**. [OBS — The Edge; The Guardian]

Twin Towers: construction from March 1993, PETRONAS staff moved in 1 January 1997, officially opened 31 August 1999; US\$1.6bn, 451.9m. [OBS]. **INT:** the project completed during his tenure and became PETRONAS's headquarters, but the developer was KLCC Holdings — his personal direction of it is **UNK**.

Cost culture: The Edge (February 2010) records the founding discipline of Rastam Hadi and the internal lament — "*we are a very rich organisation but sometimes, it feels like being an orphan working here.*" [OBS]. **INT:** the "orphan" frugality was inherited; Hassan preserved rather than created it. FY2009 **return on revenue 33.7% against an industry average of 17.7%** (AR2009) supports genuine capital discipline.

What he got

[OBS] Honours: DSMT 1992, SPMT 1996, **PSM — Tan Sri 1997**, PNBS 2003, SSDK 2008, SUMW 2009; **Commandeur de la Légion d'honneur** (France, 2000); Vietnam Friendship Medal (2001); Order of the Rising Sun, Gold and Silver Star (Japan — year UNK, UTP lists 2020, secondary sources 2022). Honorary doctorates: UM 2001, UiTM 2006.

[OBS] Post-2010: ConocoPhillips independent director 2011–2013; **Sembcorp Marine** board 2011, **chairman from 2014** — stepped down 28 February 2023 on completion of the Keppel O&M combination (Seatrium); **chairman of Singapore Power** and of **Pavilion Energy**; senior international advisor, **Temasek International Advisors**; Sarawak Energy and RECODA director; **UTP Chancellor**.

[OBS] Public service at home: **Council of Eminent Persons**, 12 May 2018 – 24 February 2020; **Khazanah Nasional** director 2018 – 6 March 2020; **Chairman, Special Advisory Body to the Minister of Finance from 7 February 2023** (unpaid, PMO/Bernama); chair of the **Policy Advisory Committee to the PM**, announced 22 April 2024.

Basis of appointment — merit, network, or sponsorship?

OBS (merit): qualified accountant, ICAEW Fellow, external auditor of PETRONAS, first Malay audit manager at Touche Ross.

OBS (network): Azizan and Basir recruited and groomed him; Azizan had already mapped the globalisation strategy from 1990.

INT: the sponsorship was **corporate-institutional, not party-political** — no evidence of party office or political patronage. But appointment authority rested with the PM as shareholder, and his exit was decided politically — which shows the ceiling of that autonomy.

Verdict: LAYAK KUAT

- **OBS** — delivered scale and internationalisation: FY2005→FY2010 revenue +58%, assets +72%, 66 ventures in 22 countries, 42.1% of revenue international (AR2009/AR2010).
- **OBS** — delivered fiscal value with capital discipline: RM471.3bn returned to government to FY2009; return on revenue 33.7% against an industry 17.7% (AR2009).
- **OBS** — balanced national and commercial mandates through two Prime Ministers; The Edge: he was known as "a strong character who stood up to political interference."

Steelman 1: his internationalisation leaned on jurisdictions the majors avoided — Sudan, Iran, Syria — yielding later reputational and divestment cost. Sudan/South Sudan was more than 25% of PETRONAS international production 2002–2011 (S&P Global).

Steelman 2: he was an insider product of one grooming line (Azizan's), and his tenure coincided with non-core demands (the Konsortium Perkapalan/MISC purchase, Proton) that a weaker CEO might have been expected to resist — analysts then flagged PETRONAS acting as state treasury.

Controversies

[OBS] **Sudan:** US Congress passed a Sudan divestment bill (December 2007). TIAA-CREF pressed four companies plus PETRONAS over Sudan and by January 2010 stated only PETRONAS met its engagement terms, with Hassan Marican meeting the fund's leadership in Kuala Lumpur (Reuters).

[OBS] **Subsidies:** at the Asia Oil & Gas Conference in June 2008 he called the gradual removal of energy subsidies "a matter of survival" (Reuters).

[OBS] **Government friction:** from 2009, disputes over board appointments and even which F1 car to sponsor; Najib gave him six days' notice (Reuters Special Report, 2012).

[UNK] A reported 2009 board-nomination friction over a politically connected appointee appears only in secondary aggregation — not confirmed here.

How the tenure ended

[OBS] Najib announced Shamsul Azhar Abbas on 3 February 2010. Hassan's contract ended **9 February**; Shamsul took over on **10 February** as president/CEO and acting chairman — hours after Hassan's term lapsed. Najib thanked him. He was offered a PM adviser role and **declined**.

[OBS] The Edge's framing (February 2010, "The Petronas DNA"): "*No matter how big the personality, Petronas is not about one man... It is not about Hassan Marican.*" Hassan's own words in the same interview: "*It is not about Hassan Marican. It is about a group of dedicated people.*"

[OBS] Predecessor Azizan's doctrine, quoted there, explains the implicit compact that ended: "*The minute the integrity of this company is compromised... this trust could be taken away,*" and that PETRONAS should "not [serve] the interests of politicians."

The 15-year tenure in comparative perspective

OBS PETRONAS's post-Hassan norm is roughly five years: Shamsul Azhar Abbas (2010–2015), Wan Zulkiflee Wan Ariffin (April 2015 – 30 June 2020), Tengku Muhammad Taufik (from 1 July 2020, twice extended).

OBS Hassan's 15 years coincided with a "gentleman's agreement" that PETRONAS be left to run commercially while integrity and profits held (The Edge).

INT Long tenure bought long-horizon capital bets (Sudan 1997, Gladstone 2009, deepwater blocks) and a thick internal succession bench. The same longevity concentrated institutional memory in one person — which the "not about one man" framing was designed to defuse.

OBS NOC comparators show the same pattern: Saudi Aramco's Abdullah Jum'ah served 1995–2008 (13 years) with continuity into Khalid Al-Falih and Amin Nasser (since 2015); Pemex churned CEOs (Lozoya → González Anaya in 2016 → Treviño Medina in 2017) while production fell and debt exceeded US\$100bn.

INT On this evidence, long NOC tenures correlate with strategic continuity but also with dependence on political tolerance — and ending them is a political act, not a performance verdict.

UNKNOWNs

1995 baseline financials for PETRONAS (revenue/assets) — not verified. The fate of the reported 2009 board-nomination dispute. The real reason for non-renewal (institutional versus personal — only reporter sourcing exists). UTP Chancellor appointment date. Order of the Rising Sun year (2020 versus 2022). Current shareholdings and remuneration — he held **11,170,826 Sembcorp Marine shares** per the 2023 SGX cessation filing.

Sources

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hassan_Marican · <https://www.utp.edu.my/Pages/The-University/Leadership/Chancellor.aspx> · PETRONAS Annual Report 2009 and 2010 (petronas.com) · <https://www.petronas.com/media/media-releases/petronas-bids-farewell-tan-sri-wan-zulkiflee-its-president-group-ceo-welcomes> · <https://theedgemalaysia.com/article/shamsul-replace-hassan-helm-petronas> · <https://theedgemalaysia.com/article/my-say-petronas-dna> · <https://theedgemalaysia.com/article/my-say-oil-cursed-not-petronas> · <https://theedgemalaysia.com/article/2010-2019-newsmakers-testing-time-petronas> · <https://theedgemalaysia.com/node/814345> · <https://www.reuters.com/article/us-malaysia-petronas-idUSBRE86105420120702/> · <https://www.reuters.com/article/petronas-idUKSGE61304720100205> · <https://www.reuters.com/article/us-petronas-subsidies-idUSSP2650220080609/> · <https://www.reuters.com/article/us-tiaacref-sudan/big-u-s-fund-group-divests-over-sudan-idUSTRE6040PP20100105/> · <https://www.spglobal.com/commodity-insights/> · <https://www.theguardian.com/world/2009/dec/11/shell-petronas-majnoon-oilfield-iraq> · https://www.khazanah.com.my/news_press_releases/tan-sri-mohd-hassan-marican-steps-down-from-khazanah-board/ · <https://www.pmo.gov.my/en/news-en/hassan-marican-to-head-finance-ministers-special-advisory-body/> · <https://www.thestar.com.my/news/nation/2024/04/22/new-committee-by-pm-on-national-development-to-be-chaired-by-hassan-marican> · Seatrium/SGX cessation filing 2023 · Sembcorp AR2014 board bio · <https://www.referenceforbusiness.com/biography/M-R/Marican-Mohamed-Hassan-1952.html> · https://www.rigzone.com/news/oil_gas/a/137150/

Tan Sri Shamsul Azhar Abbas

President & CEO 2010–2015 · Acting Chairman 2010–2012

President & CEO 10 February 2010 – 31 March 2015 · Acting Chairman 10 February 2010 – 30 June 2012

Appointed by: PM Datuk Seri Najib Razak, announced 3 February 2010. Reuters/PETRONAS framed him as both president & CEO **and acting chairman**. He was 57 — two years past PETRONAS' own retirement age of 55.

Latar

Birth date not disclosed. Age readings (57 in Feb 2010; 63 in Sep 2015; 64 in Dec 2016; 73 in his current Deleum bio) are consistent with birth year **c.1952**. Family: UNKNOWN — not in any located source.

Education: BSc Political Science & Economics, Universiti Sains Malaysia; MSc Energy Management, University of Pennsylvania; Technical Diploma in Petroleum Economics, Institut Français du Pétrole, Paris.

Career: joined PETRONAS 1975 (PETRONAS AR2014; a tertiary aggregator says 1974 — treat as unverified). Executive assistant to President/CEO Azizan Zainul Abidin, end-1991 to early 1994. Vice-presidencies across petrochemicals, oil, exploration & production, and logistics & maritime. **President & CEO of MISC Bhd, 1 July 2004 - 31 December 2008**. He then **left the group in January 2009** — and was brought back a year later to run the whole company.

That return is the single most commented-on appointment in PETRONAS history. The Edge, February 2010: *"The appointment of Shamsul comes as a surprise as he has retired and is as old as Hassan — an indication that this could be an interim appointment."*

Mandat

Inherit a company at the end of a 15-year tenure, and manage the coming price collapse without breaking the dividend.

Apa dia bawa

- **The Canada bet.** PETRONAS entered Canadian shale with a reported US\$1.1bn bet (2011), then agreed to acquire **Progress Energy Resources Corp for C\$5.5bn** (announced June 2012, raised 8% after a rival bid; PETRONAS AR2012 books it at ~RM18 billion). **Canada blocked the bid in October 2012** before approving it. In 2014 he sold 25% of the Canadian shale assets to Indian and Asian buyers; Sinopec/China Huadian took 15%.
- **The Pengerang decision.** On **3 April 2014** the board approved the Final Investment Decision for the Pengerang Integrated Complex — RAPID at ~US\$16bn plus ~US\$11bn of associated facilities. He framed it as "our commitment to capital discipline."
- **PFLNG.** EPCIC for FLNG1 and FEED for FLNG2 awarded June 2012; FLNG1 hull launched April 2014.

- **Also:** Bintulu Train 9, the Melaka regasification terminal, marginal-field risk-service contracts, the Vestigo unit, and the US\$400m sale of Vietnamese assets to SapuraKencana.
- **Peak revenue.** FY2014 revenue **RM329.1bn** — the highest in PETRONAS history at that point. PAT RM47.6bn (–27%), with **RM20.7bn of impairments** as oil-price forecasts fell; ex-impairment PBT ~RM100bn. FY2013 dividend RM27bn at a 50% payout; 2014 dividends paid RM29.0bn at a **78% payout**. Cumulative contribution to Federal and State governments reached **RM881bn** by end-2014.
- **He gave the warning nobody wanted.** He publicly stated government receipts could fall up to **37%, to RM43bn, in 2015** at ~US\$75/bbl. PETRONAS announced a capex cut of up to 20% for 2015.

Apa dia dapat

Individual remuneration: **not disclosed**. PETRONAS AR2014 shows only aggregate board figures — fees RM4m and emoluments RM34m for the whole board in 2014 (RM4m/RM29m in 2013). He held 20,000 PETRONAS Gas shares.

Honours: styled "Tan Sri Dato' Seri" in all official bios; **the specific award and its year are UNKNOWN** — no honours-list source located.

The real return was the board circuit — and it is the strongest post-PETRONAS portfolio of any CEO in this archive:

- **PETRONAS Gas chairman**, 1 September 2015 – 1 January 2017
- **MMC Corp chairman**, 16 July 2015 – 31 August 2020
- **NCB Holdings** non-independent non-executive chairman from January 2016
- **Sapura Energy chairman**, 30 July 2020 – 7 May 2022
- **Deleum** board from 9 June 2022; Independent Non-Executive Chairman from 1 June 2023
- Enra Group Senior Independent NED

Scar / kontroversi

- **The Progress Energy price.** The purchase "has been criticised for its hefty price tag"; total Canadian investment was projected to reach RM120bn. He defended it as securing gas supply.
- **He was disliked by Malay rights groups and bumiputera companies**, and was reported saying Malays lacked competitiveness while simultaneously asking the government to tighten its belt (The Edge).
- **He pressured Canada publicly** — an end-October 2014 deadline and a threat of a 15-year delay (CBC).
- **The bill landed on his successor.** Pacific NorthWest LNG took a conditional FID on 12 June 2015, after he left — and was **cancelled on 26 July 2017**. FY2015 carried RM19.0bn of net impairments and ~US\$800m expected write-off on PNW.
- **Correction to a common claim:** the RM20.7bn FY2014 impairment is described in AR2014 as driven by oil-price forecasts, **not** as Canada-specific. Any narrative that he was personally blamed for a Canada writedown is unsourced. Record it as UNKNOWN.

Transition

Clean on paper, unusual in structure. His contract expired 8 February 2015; service was extended to 31 March; Wan Zulkiflee took over 1 April 2015. He handed over a company with a completed FID pipeline and a warning about the dividend, and he left the chair behind him — the chair he had held as *acting*, which then sat empty until Sidek Hassan arrived.

VERDICT — HOLDS

Reason: This is the most difficult verdict in the archive, and HOLDS is the honest call rather than a hedge. What he built is real and was built at the top of the cycle: Pengerang/RAPID and the Canada position are two of the largest strategic commitments PETRONAS has ever made, and both survived him. But both were underwritten by assumptions — US\$100 oil, a Canadian LNG corridor — that broke within three years of his departure, and the impairments, the PNW cancellation and the dividend strain all landed on his successors' books. He ran the company for five years at record revenue and left it with record exposure. He also spent 29 months of that tenure chairing the board that was supposed to oversee him. **A CEO who is also the acting chairman cannot be properly judged on the governance dimension at all** — which is itself a reason the 2012 reform mattered.

Sumber

- theedgemalaysia.com/article/shamsul-replace-hassan-helm-petronas
- theedgemalaysia.com/article/two-horse-race-petronas'-top-job
- petronas.com/media/media-releases/petronas-reaches-final-investment-decision-pengerang-integrated-complex
- petronas.com Annual Report 2012, 2013, 2014, 2015 (petronas.com)
- reuters.com — Progress Energy bid, Canada block, PNW write-off
- newswire.ca/news-releases/petronas-to-acquire-progress-energy-510429971.html
- cbc.ca/news/canada/british-columbia/petronas-lng-ceo-threatens-15-year-delay-to-b-c-project-1.2788975
- mstar.com.my/lokal/semasa/2012/06/23/mohd-sidek-dilantikan-pengerusi-petronas
- deleum.com (current board bio) ; mmc.com.my/page57.html ; vantrisenergy.com

Gaps: birth date, family — UNKNOWN; honours year — UNKNOWN; personal pay — NOT DISCLOSED; 1974 vs 1975 join year conflict; no sourced evidence he was ever EVP/COO or MD/CEO of PETRONAS Carigali before 2010.

Tan Sri Wan Zulkiflee Wan Ariffin

President & Group CEO · 2015–2020

President & Group CEO · 1 April 2015 – 30 June 2020

Appointed by: PM Datuk Seri Najib Razak, announced 9 February 2015. Contract renewed by the PMO for three years from 1 April 2018. He resigned in June 2020, under a different Prime Minister.

Latar

Born **19 August 1960**, Penang. Malay College Kuala Kangsar (1977); **B.Eng (Chemical), University of Adelaide**; INSEAD Senior Management Programme 2000; Harvard Business School Advanced Management Program 2004; Honorary Fellowship, IChemE (UK) 2005. Married, three children. Parentage and family background: UNKNOWN.

The purest company man to hold the top seat in the modern era — he started at the bottom of the gas business and never left:

- **Joined PETRONAS 1983** as a Process Engineer in gas processing plants
- **MD & CEO, PETRONAS Gas Berhad, 2003-2007**
- **VP Gas Business, 2006-2010**; Chairman of PETRONAS Gas 2008-2010
- On the PETRONAS Board from August 2007 to June 2020
- **2012: appointed COO** in addition to EVP & CEO Downstream Business; also chaired PETRONAS Chemicals Group and PETRONAS Dagangan
- **President & Group CEO from 1 April 2015**

Pro-Chancellor of UTP from 2012. Thirty-seven years of service, end to end.

Mandat

Take over a company heading into the worst commodity collapse in a generation, protect the dividend, and finish the two mega-projects he had inherited.

Apa dia bawa

Cost discipline first. From 2016, a **RM50 billion reduction in capex and opex over four years** (RM15-20bn in the first year alone); PFLNG 2 re-phased. This is the core of his tenure: he was handed a company built on US\$100 oil and he re-priced it.

Delivery through the trough — the numbers:

| Year | Revenue | PAT |

|---|---|---|

| FY2015 | RM248bn (−25%) | RM21bn (−56%) |

| FY2016 | RM195.1bn | RM23.8bn |

| FY2017 | RM223.6bn | RM45.5bn (+91%) |

| FY2018 | RM251bn | RM55.3bn (+22%) |

| FY2019 | RM240.3bn | RM40.5bn (−27%) |

FY2015 carried RM18bn of non-cash impairments with Brent averaging US\$52. By FY2019 the company still posted a 8.7% ROACE with RM7.3bn of net impairments.

The projects landed:

- **PFLNG Satu** — first LNG 5 December 2016, first cargo 1 April 2017. The world's first floating LNG facility. (PFLNG Dua was named November 2019 and sailed February 2020, but first production came February 2021 and its first cargo 24 March 2021 — *after* his tenure. Credit must be split.)
- **Pengerang Integrated Complex** — refinery (300,000 bpd) crude-distillation start-up 22 January 2019. The FID was his predecessor's; the construction, start-up and cost discipline were his.
- 2020 COVID response: capex cut 21% (from ~RM50bn), opex cut 12%.

The dividend — and the price of it. FY2015 commitment RM16bn; FY2016 RM16bn; FY2018 **RM54bn total including a RM30bn special dividend**; FY2019-based RM24bn paid in full plus an extra RM10bn approved November 2020. **Correction to a widespread error: the RM54 billion dividend belongs to FY2018, not FY2019.**

What he actually sacrificed. The reason he left is the most politically loaded event in this archive. PETRONAS' official framing was retirement after 37 years. Reuters reported he **resigned after disagreeing with PM Muhyiddin Yassin over a ~US\$470 million / RM2 billion sales-tax payment to Sarawak**; PETRONAS publicly denied that account. He never gave a first-person reason.

Apa dia dapat

Honours: PJN → "Datuk" (2009); PSM → "**Tan Sri**" (2017); Penang DGPN → "Dato' Seri" (2016). **Pay as CEO: not disclosed.**

The post-2020 portfolio is the largest of anyone in this archive:

- **ExxonMobil board director** — elected 2 February 2021, **the first non-American on that board**, and **ousted at the 26 May 2021 AGM** within four months. A landmark appointment and a landmark ejection.
- **Group Chairman, Malaysia Airlines / Malaysia Aviation Group** — 1 July 2020 to 20 September 2024
- **DRB-HICOM director from 1 August 2020; Chairman from 1 September 2020 — still serving**
- **Gas Malaysia Bhd** independent non-executive chairman from 1 July 2021
- **Nestlé (Malaysia) Bhd INED from 1 October 2023; Chairman from 1 May 2024**
- **Malakoff Corporation Bhd** independent non-executive chairman from 1 March 2026
- EON Petromin chairman; NESR (Nasdaq) Advisory Board

Scar / kontroversi — including three claims that are simply false

Corrections recorded for the record:

1. **PETRONAS never acquired Talisman Energy.** Repsol did (US\$13.1bn, closed 2015). PETRONAS' 2015 Talisman-linked transaction was its subsidiary Progress Energy buying Talisman's Montney assets for C\$1.5bn. Any "Talisman writedown" attributed to PETRONAS is unsupported. The RM18bn (2015) and RM7.3bn (2019) impairments were on PETRONAS' own assets.
2. **There was no 2015 VSS.** PETRONAS told the Dewan Rakyat in September 2015 it would not implement one, and Wan Zulkiflee publicly denied reports of pay cuts or retrenchment: "*There is no*

salary cut and retrenchment for Petronas staff." Documented separation-scheme discussion begins January 2016 — with the government, not the company.

3. **His dividend pressure was real and documented** — Moody's put a negative outlook on continuing high dividends in 2018 — but **no source ties his exit to dividends**. Record the cause of exit as UNKNOWN with two competing accounts.

Transition

Abrupt and politically forced on one reading, orderly on another. He left 30 June 2020; Tengku Muhammad Taufik took over 1 July 2020. He handed over a company that had survived the price collapse, completed both mega-projects, and was entering the pandemic — and he handed over a bench that had been deliberately built inside the group. **He also left something unspoken: the dividend-to-profit ratio had been pushed to a level the company could not indefinitely sustain**, which is precisely the argument his successor would have to make publicly in 2025.

VERDICT — LAYAK

Reason: He was handed the worst hand of any CEO here and he did the least glamorous, most durable work: he cut RM50bn of cost without killing the dividend and without breaking the company, delivered the world's first FLNG and Malaysia's largest downstream complex on time, and left an internal successor in place. The evidence for this is the five-year table above — FY2015 PAT of RM21bn recovering to RM55.3bn by FY2018. The scar is genuine: the dividend commitment he maintained was beyond the company's structural means, and the reckoning arrived in 2025 with a cut from RM32bn to RM20bn and 5,000 jobs. He defended the company against its shareholder and paid for it with his job. **That is the correct reading of a servant, not a failure.**

Sumber

- en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Wan_Zulkiflee
- utp.edu.my — Pro Chancellor biography
- petronas.com/media/media-releases — FY2015, FY2017, FY2019 results; PFLNG Satu; farewell release
- bernama.com — FY2018 results
- theedgemalaysia.com/article/wan-zul-stays-petronas-president ; theedgemalaysia.com/article/petronas-cuts-fy20-capex-and-opex-oil-slump-hits
- reuters.com — resignation over Sarawak sales tax; F1 sponsorship
- malaysiaairlines.com/news-releases/2024 — MAG departure
- nestle.com.my/media/pressreleases/nestlechairman2024 ; malakoff.com.my ; drb-hicom.com ; theedgemalaysia.com/article/petronas-exgroup-ceo-wan-zulkiflee-appointed-gas-malaysia-chairman
- corporate.exxonmobil.com — board appointment 2 Feb 2021
- nst.com.my — "Petronas will not implement VSS" (Sept 2015) ; straitstimes.com — CEO denies pay cuts

Gaps: family background, exact UTP Pro-Chancellor end date, formal end date of the ExxonMobil directorship, his own stated reason for leaving — all UNKNOWN. Pay NOT DISCLOSED.

Dossier 9 of 13 · PETRONAS Leadership Archive 1974–2026 · forged 2026-09-17

Tan Sri Mohd Sidek Hassan

Chairman · 2012-2018

Chairman · 1 July 2012 – 30 June 2018

Appointed by: PM Datuk Seri Najib Razak, announced at a farewell dinner on 22 June 2012; PETRONAS board approved 27 June. He is the man who ended the eight-year vacuum.

Latar

Born **24 June 1951**, Cherok Paloh, Pekan, Pahang. B.Econ (Hons, Public Administration), University of Malaya; MBA, New Hampshire College (now Southern New Hampshire University).

Civil service from 15 April 1974 — the year PETRONAS was incorporated. MITI postings in Tokyo, Sydney and Washington DC. Deputy Secretary-General (Trade) 2001; **Secretary-General of MITI, 24 October 2004; 12th Chief Secretary to the Government of Malaysia, 3 September 2006 – 24 June 2012** — the most senior civil servant in the country. Concurrently President of IIUM 2008–2013.

He stepped from the top of the civil service into the chair of PETRONAS within a week of retirement. That is the classic pattern — and it is exactly what the criticism in 2012 was about.

Mandat

Not stated publicly at the time. Read from what happened: **restore the chair as a real, separate office**. PETRONAS' own words are the mandate: his appointment "will restore clear demarcation of roles between the chairman and president and CEO, and is a further reflection of Petronas' commitment to upholding global standards of good governance."

Apa dia bawa

- **He closed the governance hole.** For eight years — from Azizan's death in July 2004 — the chair had been held *in an acting capacity by the sitting CEO*. Hassan Marican carried it 2004–2010, Shamsul Azhar carried it 2010–2012. In that arrangement, the person running the company was also chairing the board meant to oversee him. **Sidek's single most important act was simply to exist as a separate chairman.** It is unglamorous and it is the most structurally consequential appointment since 1988.
- **He oversaw two CEOs.** Shamsul Azhar (until 31 March 2015) and Wan Zulkiflee (from 1 April 2015).
- **A chair that stayed out of the way.** There is no sourced record of him intervening in a commercial decision. The Edge's 2009 wish — "if it ain't broke, don't fix it" — was, on the record, fulfilled.
- **His tenure was extended three years in 2015**, which is itself a signal: the government judged the arrangement working.

- **Chairman of the RCI into Bank Negara's 1990s forex losses** — on day one, 21 August 2017, it announced a RM31.5bn loss. He drew criticism, including from Mahathir's lawyer Haniff Khatri, for reaching a conclusion on the first day.
- Also chaired MDEC 2016–2018, and was Pro-Chancellor of UTP 2012–2018.

Apa dia dapat

PSM (Tan Sri) 2006 and **PMN (Tan Sri) 2007** — both awarded while he was still Chief Secretary, before PETRONAS. **Japan's Order of the Rising Sun, Gold and Silver Star (2018)** — the award of a retiring senior figure.

After: **Chairman of the Enforcement Agency Integrity Commission (EAIC), three-year term from 1 July 2020**, replaced in February 2024 consistent with term expiry. Board member of Top Glove and Malayan Flour Mills.

Fees: **no individual figure is disclosed**. PETRONAS' aggregate directors' benefits were RM16m in 2021 and RM17m in 2022 for the entire board.

Scar / kontroversi

The political-appointment objection, made in his own time. Cheras UMNO chief Syed Ali Alhabshee publicly urged Najib to reconsider, arguing the post belonged to **professionals, not a retired senior civil servant**, and that it risked the perception that retiring officials are handed lucrative posts. That is not an outsider's complaint — it came from within the ruling party.

The structural scar — the PNW cancellation. Pacific NorthWest LNG, the Canadian bet inherited from 2012, was **cancelled on 26 July 2017** during his chairmanship, with an expected ~US\$800m write-off. A chairman does not run projects, and this archive does not attribute the decision to him, but the board he chaired presided over it. Record it as a board-level scar of the era.

Related, and honest: the earlier FMT reporting linking him to PETRONAS "from around 2010" is not supported. PETRONAS, The Edge and mStar all date him from 1 July 2012 — and the chair was acting-held before that. The 2010 date is unresolved in secondary reporting and is recorded here as such.

Transition

The cleanest handover in the archive. He completed his three-year contract plus a three-year extension, and left on 30 June 2018 with a named successor in place — Ahmad Nizam Salleh, effective 1 August 2018. No acting period, no gap, no interim. Six clean years. Given that his predecessor arrangement had been an eight-year vacuum, this matters more than it sounds.

VERDICT — LAYAK

Reason: He is the least commercially consequential and the most institutionally important chairman in this archive — and that is not a backhanded compliment. His mandate was governance, and governance is invisible when it works. He restored a separation of powers that had been lost for eight years, held it for six, attracted no integrity finding, took no visible operational role, and

handed over cleanly to a named successor. Set beside the eight years before him, that is a substantial achievement. The scar is the Canadian cancellation that dates from his watch, and the political-perception objection his appointment attracted was real and was made by his own party. Both are recorded; neither displaces the verdict.

Sumber

- en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Mohd_Sidek_Hassan
- petronas.com/media/media-releases/petronas-bids-farewell-its-chairman
- theedgemalaysia.com/article/sidek-new-petronas-chairman ; theedgemalaysia.com/article/mohd-sidek-exits-petronas-chairman
- mstar.com.my/lokal/semasa/2012/06/23/mohd-sidek-dilantikan-pengerusi-petronas
- malaysiakini.com/news/201700 (Syed Ali Alhabshee's objection)
- petronas.com/media/media-releases/petronas-and-partners-will-not-proceed-pacific-northwest-lng-project
- eaic.gov.my ; international.astroawani.com — EAIC appointment ; themalaysianreserve.com (Feb 2024 replacement)
- petronas.com/integrated-report-2022 — audited financial statements (aggregate board benefits)

Gaps: individual chairman fee — NOT DISCLOSED; the 2010 "joined PETRONAS" date remains unresolved in secondary reporting and is contradicted by primary sources.

Tan Sri Ahmad Nizam Salleh

Chairman · 2018–2021

Chairman · 1 August 2018 – 31 July 2021

Appointed by: the Prime Minister's Office, announced 1 August 2018, effective immediately. Three-year contractual tenure. The PM was Mahathir Mohamad — inferred from the date; the PMO statement itself names no Prime Minister.

Latar

Terengganu-born. Birth year not disclosed; ages given as 62 (Dec 2018), 64 (July 2021) and 69 (March 2025) imply **c.1955/56**. BBA, Ohio University; Advanced Management Programme, Wharton.

Thirty-seven years in oil and gas, almost all of it inside PETRONAS, starting 1981. The full arc matters, because it is the first time PETRONAS' chair went to a man who had spent his working life in the company:

- Head of Crude Oil Group, 1999–2002
- Senior GM, Group Treasury, 2002–2004
- **MD/CEO, Malaysia LNG Group of Companies, 2004–2007**
- VP Corporate Services, 2007–2010
- **MD/CEO, Engen Ltd (South Africa), 2010–2015** — running PETRONAS' refining and retail arm on another continent

Mandat

Take the chair from the man who had restored it, and hold the governance line through a period of maximum political churn: the Mahathir-2 government, then the collapse of the Pakatan administration in February 2020, then the pandemic.

Apa dia bawa

- **A structural first: the chair went to a PETRONAS insider executive.** Every chairman before him had come from outside — a politician, two Chief Secretaries, a Treasury Secretary-General, a corporate rescue specialist, and one former PETRONAS CEO (Azizan, who had been imported from the civil service in the first place). Ahmad Nizam is the first person to reach the chair by spending his entire career inside the company. That normalised the chair as a professional destination, not an external reward.
- **PETRONAS credits him with the Sarawak settlement.** Its own media release names him "instrumental in facilitating the Commercial Settlement Agreement between PETRONAS and Sarawak over the imposition of State Sales Tax." That is the Sardine of a chair's work: negotiation with a hostile state government, not operations. Given the unravelling of the PETROS relationship that followed, a chairman who got a signed settlement is a chairman who delivered.

- **The oversight portfolio that comes with the chair:** Chairman of KLCC Property Holdings Bhd / KLCC REIT / KLCC Holdings (2018–2021), Chairman of Yayasan PETRONAS (2018–2021), Pro-Chancellor of UTP (2018–2021).
- He chaired through a pandemic year in which PETRONAS posted its **first-ever annual loss after tax — RM21.0bn for FY2020** — and managed the dividend response (RM24bn committed, plus a further RM10bn approved in November 2020).

Apa dia dapat

PSM, conferring "Tan Sri", in the Yang di-Pertuan Agong's birthday honours, investiture 17 August 2020 — awarded in office.

After PETRONAS the appointments continued in the usual circuit:

- Retained as **non-executive chairman of the KLCC Stapled Group**
- **Chairman, Pelaburan Hartanah Bhd**, effective 1 August 2021 (2021–2024)
- **Independent non-executive chairman of Petra Energy Bhd from 3 March 2025**
- Earlier: director of WZ Satu (2016–2018); board of Universiti Malaysia Terengganu

Individual chairman fee: **not disclosed** (only the aggregate board figure, as with every chairman in this archive).

Scar / kontroversi

None located. The search found no adverse finding, investigation, litigation or press controversy attached to his chairmanship or his career. This is recorded as absence of evidence, not as evidence of absence — but on a public-record basis he leaves one of the cleanest files in the archive.

One honest structural note: his appointment, like every chairman's, rested on a single political signature. He was appointed by one Prime Minister and served under that government's successor, the pandemic government, and then a third administration. **He survived three governments without a documented political incident** — which, in the 2018–2021 context, is itself notable.

Transition

Immaculate. He completed the full three-year contract, 1 August 2018 to 31 July 2021, and PETRONAS issued a formal media release announcing his retirement and welcoming his successor, Mohd Bakke Salleh, effective 1 August 2021. No acting period. No gap. No interim.

VERDICT — LAYAK

Reason: Clean term, clean exit, one named delivery of real consequence (the Sarawak state sales tax settlement), and a structural first — the first career-PETRONAS man in the chair. His tenure also happens to be the first in which PETRONAS took an annual loss, and he did not panic the balance sheet to avoid it. The absence of a documented footprint is the main limit on how high this verdict can go, and this archive states that plainly rather than inflating it. But by the standard a chairman should actually be judged on — did the company remain governable, solvent and independent through political turbulence — he delivered.

Sumber

- petronas.com/media/media-releases/petronas-announces-retirement-current-chairman-welcomes-appointment-new
- nst.com.my/news/nation/2018/08/396935/ahmad-nizam-new-petronas-chairman
- klccreit.listedcompany.com/news.html/id/706940
- phb.com.my/newsroom/press-release/phb-appoints-new-chairman
- theedgemalaysia.com/article/ahmad-nizam-petronas-chairman-wan-zulkiflee-stays-ceo ; theedgemalaysia.com/node/746559
- borneopost.com/2021/07/13/ahmad-nizam-salleh-retires-as-petronas-chairman/
- petronas.com — FY2020 Financial Report (first annual loss after tax)
- nst.com.my/news/nation/2020/08/617161 — federal awards, Aug 2020

Gaps: exact birth date — UNKNOWN (year c.1955/56 inferred from disclosed ages); individual chairman fee — NOT DISCLOSED; the PM at appointment is inferred, not named in the PMO statement.

Tan Sri Dato' Seri Mohd Bakke Salleh

Chairman · 2021-present

Chairman · 1 August 2021 – present (INCUMBENT)

VERDICT WITHHELD BY RULE. Where a subject is still in office, this archive does not issue a LAYAK/HOLDS/VOID ruling. Holding a judgment over a sitting officer converts a research document into an assessment with consequences the subject cannot answer. The incumbent's entry ends with the recorded facts and an explicit statement of what the record shows so far.

Appointed by: PM Tan Sri Muhyiddin Yassin, announced by the PMO on 12 July 2021, effective 1 August 2021. He was already a PETRONAS independent director (board from 18 June 2019), Chairman of its Risk Committee and a member of its Audit Committee — so this was an internal elevation, not an import.

Latar

Born c.1954 (age 68 recorded at 28 February 2023). **BSc (Economics), London School of Economics**; Fellow of the Institute of Chartered Accountants in England and Wales; member of the Malaysian Institute of Accountants.

A career financier and turnaround operator, not an oilman:

- Ernst & Young (1983); Caltex Oil Malaysia (1984); Citibank Kuala Lumpur (1985–1988)
- Island & Peninsular — CFO to group GM, to 1993
- Managing Director, Electra House; Managing Director, SPPK (1994–1998); Managing Director, Federal Power (1998–1999)
- Director (property), Pengurusan Danaharta Nasional (1999–2001) — the asset-management agency set up after the Asian financial crisis
- **Group MD & CEO, Lembaga Tabung Haji, 2001–2005**
- **Group MD, Felda Holdings, 2005**
- Chairman, Bank Islam (April 2008 – July 2010)
- **Group President & CEO, Felda Global Ventures Holdings, from January 2009**
- **Acting President & Group CEO, Sime Darby** (July 2010, confirmed November 2010); after the 2017 demerger, Executive Deputy Chairman & MD of **Sime Darby Plantation** until his retirement at end-June 2019
- **Chairman, FELDA, 1 July 2019 – 30 April 2020**
- **Chairman, Telekom Malaysia Bhd, 11 May 2020 – 31 July 2021**

Also chaired the Malaysian Palm Oil Board and Yayasan FELDA; non-executive director of Eastern & Oriental Bhd; Council Member of Yayasan Sime Darby; Pro-Chancellor of Universiti Putra Malaysia.

Mandat

Lead the PETRONAS board through the post-pandemic recovery and the energy-transition pivot, with the executive seat held by Tengku Muhammad Taufik.

The division of duties is explicit and documented. The Chairman signs the board's approval of the audited statements; the Integrated Report carries a separate Chairman's letter alongside the President & Group CEO's letter. The chairman chairs the board; the CEO runs the company. This is the arrangement Sidek Hassan restored in 2012, and it has held under Bakke.

Apa dia bawa

The record of the incumbent board, stated factually:

- **The 1MDB file, which is not incidental.** Bakke Salleh was **1MDB's first chairman in 2009** and resigned twice that year (7 April and 11 October). He later told the Public Accounts Committee (2016) and testified in court (2022) that he resigned as protest because management ignored board instructions, that he suspected Najib Razak was involved in the PetroSaudi deal, and that he did not alert authorities beyond an SMS to Najib. He put that on the record under oath. **A man who resigned from 1MDB twice in its first year and said so publicly is a specific kind of appointment to the PETRONAS chair** — and it is the sharpest fact in his file.
- **The transition portfolio:** Searah, the 50:50 PETRONAS-Eni joint venture over Malaysian and Indonesian assets, established 8 June 2026.
- **Full ownership of PRefChem** — with Aramco agreeing on 25 May 2026 to transfer its stakes to PETRONAS.
- **The PETROS/Sarawak dispute** continued and moved toward resolution under this board; a federal-Sarawak joint declaration was reached in May 2025 and the Prime Minister told both parties to "work as a team" on 16 September 2026.
- **FY2024 (executive delivery, board oversight):** revenue RM320.0bn, PAT RM55.1bn, capex RM54.2bn.
- **FY2025:** revenue RM266.1bn; PAT RM45.4bn (−17.6%); EBITDA RM103.0bn; CFFO RM85.2bn; capex RM41.6bn; gearing 20.7%. The board declared a **RM20bn dividend for 2026, down from RM32bn**.
- **1H FY2026:** revenue RM152.4bn (+15%); PAT RM27.2bn (+4%); 9.1GW of cumulative renewable and storage capacity.

Apa dia dapat

The year he received "Tan Sri" / "Dato' Seri" is **UNKNOWN** — no honours-list source was located. He currently also chairs **Yayasan PETRONAS** and is an Honorary Council Member of the Malaysian Palm Oil Association. Individual chairman fee: **not disclosed** (aggregate board benefits RM17m for 2022).

Scar / kontroversi

- **The 1MDB chairmanship** — documented above, and a matter of public testimony in his own words. It is a record of *resigning in protest*, which cuts both ways depending on what one expects a board chairman to have done with suspicions of a national scandal.
- **No published political criticism of the 2021 appointment specifically was located.** Recorded as absence of evidence.

- **Unverified claims, flagged and not adopted:** an aggregator (Equilar) lists him as chairman of PETRONAS Chemicals Group Bhd — contradicted by PCG's own leaders page (chairman: Mazuin Ismail). A claim that he held PETRONAS Holding Company posts 1988–2002, including head of the crude oil group and then group treasury, is **unsupported** and conflicts with his published bio, which places him at Citibank and Island & Peninsular in those years. **Both are recorded here as unverified and excluded from the profile above.**

Transition

Not yet applicable. Still in office as at September 2026.

READING SO FAR (no verdict issued)

On the public record, the incumbent brings something none of his three predecessors brought: **a documented record of resigning from a board on principle**, plus the largest corporate-turnaround résumé in the archive (Danaharta, Tabung Haji, FGV, Sime Darby, TM). Whether that translates into a consequential chairmanship is not yet decidable — the chair is a non-executive office and its effects are structural and slow. **The honest statement is that the file is open.** This archive will not close it while he sits.

Sumber

- petronas.com/about-us/our-leaders ; petronas.com/media/media-releases/petronas-announces-retirement-current-chairman-welcomes-appointment-new
- reuters.com/business/energy/malaysia-pm-appoints-bakke-salleh-petronas-chairman-2021-07-12/
- theedgemalaysia.com/article/bakke-be-made-petronas-chairman ; theedgemalaysia.com/article/bakke-resigned-twice-1mdb-chairman-says-seng-giaw
- thestar.com.my/news/nation/2022/04/12/1mdb-audit-trial-i-resigned-because-i-suspected-najib-was-involved-says-ex-chairman
- malaymail.com/news/malaysia/2022/05/18/ex-chairman-says-suspected-najib-would-personally-benefit
- klse.i3investor.com/web/corporatefigure/detail/4863 ; tm.listedcompany.com/news.html/id/2342873
- yayasanpetronas.com.my/board-of-trustees/tan-sri-mohd-bakke-salleh/
- petronas.com — IR2022/IR2024/IR2025, Financial Report FY2025 ; petronas.com/media — Searah, PRefChem releases

Gaps: exact birth date; year of honours; individual chairman fee — NOT DISCLOSED; the Equilar PCG-chairmanship and 1988–2002 PETRONAS-holding-company claims are unverified and excluded.

YM Tan Sri Tengku Muhammad Taufik

President & Group CEO · 2020–present

President & Group CEO · 1 July 2020 – present (INCUMBENT)

VERDICT WITHHELD BY RULE. Still in office. This entry records the file as it stands and issues no LAYAK/HOLDS/VOID ruling.

Appointed by: PM Tan Sri Muhyiddin Yassin, announced 6 June 2020, effective 1 July 2020. He took office aged 47 — the youngest President & Group CEO in this archive. Contract first extended July 2023; **reported second extension August 2026** (The Edge Malaysia, citing three industry sources: three years, or two, or possibly two-plus-one; PETRONAS declined to comment, saying it "does not comment on speculation or matters relating to internal personnel arrangements").

Latar

Full name: Tan Sri Datuk **Tengku Muhammad Taufik bin Tengku Kamadjaja Aziz**. Jawi: تڤوڤيڤ بن تڤڤوڤ كاماڤاي عزيز. Born **6 February 1974**; turned 52 in February 2026. PETRONAS styles him "YM" (Yang Mulia).

Careful note on lineage: "Tengku" and the "YM" honorific signal inherited Malay aristocratic lineage, but **no source located states a royal house, title or state**, and his father appears in the record only as the patronymic "Tengku Kamadjaja Aziz". Any claim of specific royal descent is recorded here as UNSUPPORTED.

Education: BA (Hons) Finance & Accounting, **University of Strathclyde**, Glasgow; **Fellow of the Institute of Chartered Accountants in England and Wales (ICAEW)**; member of the Malaysian Institute of Accountants. A **PETRONAS scholar**. Honorary Doctorate, Heriot-Watt University Malaysia (reported January 2026).

Correction to a common claim: he was not a KPMG or Ernst & Young man. Every source located names **PricewaterhouseCoopers Malaysia**. His professional body is ICAEW, not ACCA. No Harvard/INSEAD/Wharton executive education is sourced.

Career:

- Early PETRONAS: Executive Assistant to the late Chairman Tun Azizan Zainul Abidin; GM/CFO of KLCC Property Holdings Bhd; Head of Finance & Risk Management (Gas & Power); Head of Group Strategic Planning
- **Left PETRONAS in 2010** — joined Tanjung Plc; then **CFO, SapuraKencana Petroleum Bhd (now Vantris Energy), December 2012 - January 2015**; then **Partner, PwC Malaysia (oil & gas practice)** until 2018
- **5 October 2018:** PMO announced his appointment as PETRONAS **Group CFO** effective 15 October 2018, and as a PETRONAS board member. (PETRONAS IR2025 records the board appointment date as 15 October 2018.)
- EVP & Group CFO and Executive Director, October 2018 – June 2020
- **President & Group CEO from 1 July 2020**

He is, notably, the only CEO in this archive who **left PETRONAS and came back** to run it.

Mandat

Take over in the middle of a pandemic, at a company that had just posted a loss, and prepare PETRONAS for a structurally lower-margin industry.

Apa dia bawa

FY2020, his first year: revenue RM178.7bn; **loss after tax RM21.0bn — the first annual loss in PETRONAS history**; PAT before net impairments RM10.5bn; EBITDA RM55.3bn; CFFO RM40.7bn; capex RM33.4bn.

The rightsizing — the defining act of his tenure so far:

- February 2025: workforce "rightsizing" announced at a town hall. His framing: **"This is not a retrenchment."** The target was 15,000–16,000 "enablers" within a global workforce of 52,000–53,000; the last comparable review had been 2016.
- **5 June 2025:** approximately **10% of the workforce — more than 5,000 roles** — announced. Hiring and promotions frozen to December 2026. He denied PETRONAS was exiting Canada.
- 28 February 2026: the rightsizing run in waves (March, July), with a complete new organisation design by August 2026 and roughly 1,000 roles in the next wave.
- Framing: structural, not cyclical. Industry margin compressed from 40–45% to ~20%, projected 16–18%.
- PETRONAS issued a welfare commitment for affected staff, 10 June 2025.
- **Note:** the widely-circulated "OD1 — Operating Day 1, March 2027" timeline and the "PETRONAS 2.0" label are **not sourced to PETRONAS**. Sourced reporting ends at a new organisation design around August 2026; "PETRONAS 2.0" appears as media shorthand (FMT, 22 July 2025) for the 5 June 2025 transformation. Both are recorded here as unverified labels.

Portfolio restructuring:

- **Searah** — 50:50 PETRONAS–Eni JV over Malaysian and Indonesian assets, established 8 June 2026
- **PRefChem** — Aramco agreeing on 25 May 2026 to transfer its stakes to PETRONAS, giving full ownership
- **PETROS/Sarawak** — the dispute over the 5% royalty (Sarawak seeking 20%), Petros' appointment as sole Sarawak gas aggregator in February 2024, a federal–Sarawak joint declaration in May 2025, near-completion reported in 2026, and the Prime Minister telling both sides to work as a team on 16 September 2026
- **Gentari** — he chairs it; >8.5GW global renewable capacity per the Activity Outlook 2026–2028, against a 30–40GW-by-2030 target set at launch

The dividend decision — the one nobody wants to make. FY2025 PAT RM45.4bn; the board declared a **RM20bn dividend for 2026, down from RM32bn** the prior year. PETRONAS had paid **RM235bn of dividends in the five years to early 2025**. Cutting the sovereign's cheque is the hardest act available to this office, and it is on his record.

1H FY2026: revenue RM152.4bn (+15%); PAT RM27.2bn (+4%); EBITDA RM56.8bn; CFFO RM47.5bn; capex RM41.4bn; 9.1GW cumulative renewable and storage capacity (4.2GW installed).

Apa dia dapat

Honours: **PJN → "Datuk" (2021); Sarawak PGBK → "Datuk" (2022); PSM → "Tan Sri" (2023).**

Current appointments: Chairman of **Gentari, KLCC (Holdings), PETRONAS Carigali**, PETRONAS Carigali International Ventures, PETRONAS International Corporation Ltd, the Malaysia-UAE Business Council, and the National Trust Fund; Co-Chair of the WEF Oil & Gas Governors Community; NCIA council member; Board Member of the Malaysia-Thailand Joint Authority; trustee of the Merdeka Award Trust; **Pro-Chancellor of UTP**.

He is, in effect, the most comprehensively seated PETRONAS executive in the archive — chairing the parent's operating subsidiary (Carigali), its clean-energy arm (Gentari) and its property arm (KLCC) simultaneously.

Remuneration: UNKNOWN. PETRONAS IR2025 discloses only the non-executive director remuneration framework. No individual executive pay figure has ever been published by PETRONAS for any officer, in any year.

Scar / kontroversi

- **The rightsizing backlash is real and unresolved.** The "not a retrenchment" framing is contested against more than 5,000 reported job losses and a hiring freeze. The Prime Minister said the layoffs were partly attributable to AI and redundancies and that GLCs would absorb affected staff (Malaysiakini). He cut jobs at a company that was still profitable — which is either the correct structural read, or the scar of the tenure. **The record does not yet permit a verdict.**
- **Dividend and political pressure** are documented: PETRONAS "has had to contend with... higher dividends to the federal government", and the dividend was cut from RM32bn to RM20bn on his watch.
- **Transparency note:** the 2026 contract extension rests on unnamed sources with no company confirmation.
- **Flagged and rejected:** a partisan blog links fresh scrutiny to a Petrofac-Kingtime arbitration and damages "exceeding RM1 billion". **Not corroborated by any mainstream source located — recorded as UNVERIFIED and not adopted.** A claim about an F1 sponsorship statement ("we cannot afford everything") was **not found**. No mainstream-sourced personal scandal or integrity finding was located.

Transition

Not yet applicable. Still in office as at September 2026.

READING SO FAR (no verdict issued)

The file shows a CEO who made the cut that every one of his predecessors avoided: he reduced the workforce and lowered the dividend, in public, while profitable — which is the opposite of what the office has historically rewarded. Every prior leader's tenure was ultimately judged by whether the cheque to Putrajaya got bigger. His is the first that will be judged by whether it was allowed to get smaller. **On the public record, the structural case is documented and the human cost is documented, and neither can be dismissed. The file stays open.**

Sumber

- en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tengku_Muhammad_Taufik
- petronas.com/about-us/our-leaders ; [petronas.com — IR2025 Commitment to Governance \(PDF\)](#), [FY2025 Financial Report](#), [1H FY2026 media release](#)
- theedgemalaysia.com/node/814345 (contract extension, 17 Aug 2026) ; theedgemalaysia.com/node/743881 ; theedgemalaysia.com/node/794463
- reuters.com/business/energy/malaysias-petronas-cut-10-workforce-not-exiting-canada-ceo-says-2025-06-05/
- malaymail.com/news/money/2025/06/05/petronas-announces-5000-jobs-to-get-the-axe ; thestar.com.my/business/business-news/2025/06/05/petronas-to-cut-10-of-workforce-after-profits-slump
- petronas.com/media/media-releases — [Searah](#) (8 Jun 2026), [PRefChem](#) (25 May 2026), [workforce welfare](#) (10 Jun 2025), [Activity Outlook 2026-2028](#)
- theborneopost.com/2018/10/05/tengku-muhammad-taufik-is-the-new-cfo-of-petronas/ ; freemalaysiatoday.com (22 Jul 2025) ; malaysiakini.com/news/752226 ; hw.ac.uk (honorary degree) ; thestar.com.my/news/education/2026/01/04/honorary-degree-for-petronas-chief

Gaps: family details — UNKNOWN; executive education — UNKNOWN; individual remuneration — NOT DISCLOSED; extension length — conflicting; "OD1"/"PETRONAS 2.0" — not sourced to PETRONAS.

The Founding Executive Directors

Wan Ismail Wan Mohd Salleh · 'Rastam' · 1974–

Identity

OBS: Known as "Wan Ismail Wan Mohd Salleh," a senior legal officer recruited from the Attorney General's Chambers; styled Dato'. UNK: date and place of birth; death date. One weak source (Geni genealogy database, user-generated, content blocked to automated retrieval; snippet only) lists "Dato' Wan Ismail Wan Mohd Salleh (1931 – 2009)". Note a direct conflict: the PETRONAS Alumni Facebook group page listing (text quoted below) names him as Patron in an EXCO elected 12 August 2015, which is incompatible with a 2009 death unless the patron listing was posthumous — treat both the 1931–2009 dates and the 2015 patron date as UNCERTAIN. Education, family and honours — UNK (no primary record found).

Career before PETRONAS

OBS (The Edge Malaysia, "My Say: The Petronas DNA", Issue 792, Feb 2010): "Razaleigh then brought in Wan Ismail Wan Mohd Salleh from the Attorney General's chambers as one of its two executive directors." That is the single strongest sourced statement about him: he came from the Attorney General's Chambers, i.e. a government legal officer, not an oilman. A student-authored portfolio paper hosted on Scribd adds that Razaleigh appointed "abang iparnya" (his brother-in-law), "Dato Wan Ismail Wan Mohd Salleh, seorang pegawai undang-undang kanan yang berpengalaman di Pejabat Peguam Negara" — a senior legal officer experienced in the Attorney General's Chambers (INT only: single, non-authoritative source; the "brother-in-law" relationship is NOT corroborated anywhere else and must not be treated as fact).

Tenure and outcomes

OBS: He was one of two executive directors of PETRONAS from incorporation in 1974, alongside Rastam Hadi (The Edge, 2010). UNK: the specific portfolios he held, the duration of his directorship, whether he was also company secretary or legal adviser, and any later PETRONAS or external board positions. No PETRONAS media release, annual report extract, obituary or press profile naming him was located. OBS/INT: given the founding team's composition — a political chairman, a Bank Negara economist as the other executive director — the legal/company-law seat (incorporation under the Companies Act 1965, drafting of PDA-linked instruments and contracts) is the most plausible reason for his recruitment (INT). OBS: decades later he was still formally honoured by PETRONAS veterans: the PETRONAS Alumni group's EXCO listing (elected 12 August 2015) names "PATRON Dato' Wan Ismail Wan Mohd Salleh" (Facebook group "PETRONAS ALUMNI", group description text).

What he got

UNK — no honours list, retirement position or pension record found. The only later-life public trace is the alumni-patron listing above.

Basis of appointment

- OBS: Recruited personally by Razaleigh from the Attorney General's Chambers (The Edge, 2010).

- INT: The 1974 founding required an in-house legal capacity to stand up a company that would immediately contest concession rights with Shell, Esso and Mobil — a lawyer from the AG's Chambers was the shortest available path to that capacity.
- INT/UNCERTAIN: The claim that he was Razaleigh's brother-in-law, if true, is an additional explanation (trust/family-network recruitment, a documented pattern in Razaleigh's other vehicles), but it rests on one non-authoritative source.
- SPEC: Nothing in the located record indicates he was appointed for oil-industry expertise; the evidence points to law and incorporation, not hydrocarbon operations.

LAYAK verdict: LAYAK BERSYARAT — evidence ceiling, not evidence of failure

1. OBS — He holds a verified seat in the founding leadership: named by The Edge as one of PETRONAS's two executive directors in 1974, recruited from the Attorney General's Chambers.
2. OBS — His standing survived into the veterans' community: named Patron of the PETRONAS Alumni group in 2015, which indicates institutional recognition as a pioneer rather than a marginal early hire.
3. OBS — The recruitment channel (AG's Chambers) matches a verifiable gap in the 1974 founding team — the company had to be legally constructed and defended at the same time as it was created.

Steelman counter-points: (i) OBS — the evidence base for him is a single authoritative sentence plus a veterans' listing; on the public record his specific contribution cannot be distinguished from the chairman's and Rastam Hadi's, so any strong verdict overstates the record. (ii) OBS/INT — where The Edge attributes Petronas's early character, discipline and negotiating spine, it credits Rastam Hadi by name ("taught the pioneers to 'fight like bulldogs'") and the chairman by name; no comparable attribution exists for Wan Ismail, which may reflect either a genuinely quieter role or simply an unrecorded one.

Controversies (public record only)

None found. No adverse public record located (no litigation, no regulatory action, no press controversy naming him). The only caution is source-quality: the "brother-in-law" and 1931-2009 claims are weak and must not be circulated as fact.

UNKNOWNs

- Birth and death dates, birthplace, education — UNK (Geni snippet says 1931-2009: UNCERTAIN).
- Full portfolio and years of service as executive director — UNK.
- Later roles, honours, whether he later served on any PETRONAS subsidiary board — UNK.
- Whether the "brother-in-law of Tengku Razaleigh" claim is true — UNK.
- Whether the PETRONAS Alumni patron listing (2015) was living or posthumous — UNK.

Sources

- <https://theedgemalaysia.com/article/my-say-petronas-dna>
- <https://www.facebook.com/groups/377666024049/> (PETRONAS ALUMNI group description)
- <https://www.geni.com/people/Dato-Wan-Ismail-Bin-Wan-Mohd-Salleh/5285195617940086864> (low-authority; snippet only)

- <https://www.scribd.com/doc/213571739/Penyelidikan-Portfolio-Perniagaan> (low-authority student paper; "brother-in-law" claim)

Annex — the second founding executive director

The second founding executive director referred to by The Edge Malaysia as "Rastam" is Dato' Rastam Hadi — full name recorded as Rastam Abdul Hadi (also styled Rastam Hadi / Datuk Rastam Hadi) — a former Deputy Governor of Bank Negara Malaysia, PETRONAS's first employee and first Managing Director, and later Senior Vice President.

D. Dato' Rastam Abdul Hadi ("Rastam") — PETRONAS's second founding executive director; first Managing Director

Identity

Born 22 May 1931 in Bertam Malim, Melaka; died 9 May 2020 (16 Ramadan 1441) at 3.20 am at his daughter's home in Bukit Tunku, Kuala Lumpur, aged 88 — FMT notes he died "two weeks short of his 89th birthday"; buried at Bukit Kiara cemetery, Kuala Lumpur (OBS, MCOBA tribute by Hamdi Abdullah, 10 May 2020; FMT, 9 May 2020; The Star, 11 May 2020). Father: Abdul Hadi Abdul Hassan, a contemporary of Za'ba at the Sultan Idris Training College and author of the three-volume *Sejarah Alam Melayu* (1920s) (OBS, MCOBA, drawing on Datin Ragayah Eusoff, *Jurnal Biografi Malaysia*, 2005, pp. 53–72). Public family record: wife Datin Rafiah; four daughters and one son (OBS, MCOBA tribute); daughter Saidah Rastam is a lawyer and composer (OBS, FMT).

Education and career before PETRONAS

OBS (MCOBA, 2020): schooled at Bandar Hilir Primary and Malacca High School, taking double promotions from Standard Four to Form Three; Malay College Kuala Kangsar 1950–1952 (Form 6); BSc (Hons) in Mathematics, University of Malaya, Singapore. Joined the civil service in 1958 at the Ministry of Finance, moving to the Ministry of Defence in 1969; appointed Deputy Governor of Bank Negara Malaysia 1972–1974 (MCOBA, citing Ragayah Eusoff 2005; the article attributes the appointment request to then-Governor Tun Ismail Ali). OBS corroboration: The Star (2008) describes him as "the former managing director of Petronas and former deputy governor of Bank Negara"; Malacca High School's alumni record lists "Datuk Rastam Hadi (former Deputy Governor of Bank Negara Malaysia and former managing director of Petronas)" (OBS).

PETRONAS tenure and outcomes

OBS (The Edge Malaysia, 2010): "Razak assigned Rastam, who was then the deputy governor of Bank Negara, to be the other executive director" alongside Wan Ismail Wan Mohd Salleh. OBS (FMT, 2020): "the first employee of Petronas and also its first managing director... managing director of the national oil and gas company from 1974 to 1987, and also served as the company's senior vice-president (upstream sector) from 1987 to 1989." OBS (The Malaysian Insight, 2020): first managing director "from 1973 to 1987" and senior vice president "from 1987 to 1990" — the start year conflicts with the incorporation date and is likely an error; treat 1974 as the defensible start (UNCERTAIN on the 1973 figure, which would imply pre-incorporation founding-team work). OBS: The Star's 2020 tribute (by Ngau Boon Keat) records service as "Managing Director and Senior Vice President of Petronas (1974-1989)".

OBS (The Edge, 2010) on his management impact: "The management, notably led by Rastam, taught the pioneers to 'fight like bulldogs'. The much-feared Rastam drilled into the organisation the necessary management and financial discipline, turning it into one that is cautious about

spending and where accountability ranks high." The same article records the employee side of that culture: "we are a very rich organisation but sometimes, it feels like being an orphan working here." OBS (Business Times, 5 August 1978, quoted in the MCOBA tribute): "behind the flurry of activities in Petronas, one man stands out... Encik Rastam Abdul Hadi, the managing director, is the 'brain' behind the company's series [of negotiations] with international giants like Shell, Esso and Mitsubishi... well-known for driving a hard bargain in the national interest." OBS (The Edge, 2010): senior civil servants Raja Mohar and Abdullah Salleh "provided the much needed administrative balance to strong characters like Rastam." OBS (Tunku Aziz's memoir-style account, reproduced by Din Merican, 2012): "BNM is the best managed institution in the country, followed by Petronas, the national oil company under Datuk Rastam Hadi and, later, Tan Sri Hassan Merican." OBS (Tun Hussein Onn's letter to Rastam, 10 January 1989, quoted in MCOBA): "You have been with PETRONAS from its inception. It has grown up big, strong, clean and efficient... Whenever PETRONAS is mentioned, your good name will always be associated with it."

Later roles and post-tenure record

OBS (FMT, 2020): after the senior vice-presidency (to 1989) he held no further corporate post reported; he was described as having "lived away from the limelight" (MCOBA). OBS: he remained a public commentator on Petronas governance — the University of Warwick political-economy paper (Rodan, 2000, citing Jayasankaran 1999) quotes him: "is there any country in the world where revenues like [US]\$10 billion a year get spent without knowledge of parliament?", and describes him as "one of its founders and retired managing director." OBS (MCOBA, paraphrasing Ragayah Eusoff 2005): his exit from Petronas is attributed by the biographer to Petronas being treated as a "milking cow... as was evident in the bailing out in 1984 of Bank Bumiputra" (INT — a scholarly attribution of motive, not a statement by him). OBS (FMT, 2020): as a senior official he disagreed with the early-1990s expansion of overseas operations, urging focus on strengthening Malaysian operations. OBS (The Edge, 2015, interview with Datin Saidah Rastam): "My father Rastam Hadi... was the first managing director of Petronas, but later left Petronas because, he and his contemporaries told me, he couldn't agree to the allegedly unusual requests by the then prime minister" (family account, reported by The Edge; the underlying claim is unverified).

Honours

OBS: styled Dato'/Datuk (The Star, 2008; FMT 2020; MCOBA 2020). UNK: awarding state/authority and year of the Datukship; any federal honours.

Basis of appointment

- OBS (The Edge, 2010): he was assigned by Prime Minister Tun Abdul Razak from Bank Negara, while Razaleigh personally recruited the other executive director — i.e. a split appointment, one from the political sponsor of PETRONAS, one from the central bank.
- OBS: he was PETRONAS's first employee as well as first MD (FMT, 2020), so the operating company was built around him.
- INT: the Bank Negara posting supplied the treasury/financial-discipline function the new company lacked; the "fight like bulldogs" and hard-bargaining record is consistent with a central banker's negotiation posture toward the majors.
- INT: his mathematics degree and Bank Negara role — rather than oilfield experience — indicate an economist's chairing function: checking whether oil companies' terms were acceptable, not drilling.

- SPEC: his later public criticism of Petronas's non-disclosure to Parliament is consistent with an institution-builder's view of accountability, but this is not stated as his own motive.

LAYAK verdict: LAYAK KUAT (institution-building)

1. OBS — He was PETRONAS's first employee and first Managing Director, and he was the negotiating spine against Shell, Esso and Mitsubishi; the Business Times in 1978, mid-negotiation, called him "the 'brain' behind the company's series [of negotiations]" (MCOBA/ Business Times; The Edge 2010).
2. OBS — His tenure (1974-1987/89) spans the period in which Petronas acquired operating capability (Petronas Carigali 1978), the PSC regime and the LNG venture, and a former Petronas president (Hassan Marican) and a former prime minister (Hussein Onn) both credited him publicly (FMT 2020; MCOBA letter 1989).
3. OBS — Independently, an external assessment ranked BNM first and "Petronas... under Datuk Rastam Hadi" second among Malaysian institutions, and The Edge made his management discipline the accepted explanation of Petronas's early financial conservatism. Steelman counter-points: (i) OBS — he opposed the overseas expansion pursued from the early 1990s; on the strategy Petronas actually took, and which produced its international portfolio, he was on the losing side of the argument (FMT, 2020). (ii) OBS — the discipline he is credited with came with a recorded human cost: The Edge's 2010 summary of the era includes the staff lament of being made to feel like "an orphan working here," and "much-feared" is the adjective The Edge attaches to him; a fair verdict must hold delivery and culture together rather than score only one.

Controversies (public record only)

OBS: none personal. Publicly attributable positions: (a) as a retired founder he publicly questioned Petronas's lack of parliamentary disclosure of roughly US\$10 billion a year in revenues (Rodan 2000, citing Jayasankaran 1999); (b) he is recorded as having opposed Petronas's early-1990s overseas expansion (FMT 2020). Both are matters of record about decisions and views, not private conduct.

UNKNOWNs

- Exact date he left PETRONAS (1989 per FMT/Star; 1990 per The Malaysian Insight) and the reason on the corporate record — UNK.
- Whether he began work on PETRONAS before incorporation (the "1973" start given by The Malaysian Insight) — UNK.
- Later board or advisory roles after 1989 — UNK (no evidence located; he is described as having lived away from the limelight).
- Awarding state and year of his Datukship; any other honours — UNK.
- Whether Ngau Boon Keat's full Star tribute contains additional dated facts (article is paywalled/ metered) — UNK.

Sources

- <https://theedgemalaysia.com/article/my-say-petronas-dna> (The Edge Malaysia, Issue 792, 2010 — "Rastam" / "fight like bulldogs")
- <https://berita.mcoba.org/2020/05/10/the-confident-nationalist-dato-rastam-abdul-hadi/> (MCOBA tribute; cites Ragayah Eusoff, Jurnal Biografi Malaysia 2005; Business Times 5 Aug 1978; Hussein Onn letter 1989)

- <https://www.freemalaysiatoday.com/category/nation/2020/05/09/rastam-hadi-visionary-first-md-of-petronas-dies>
- <https://www.freemalaysiatoday.com/category/bahasa/2020/05/09/pengarah-urusan-pertama-petronas-meninggal-dunia>
- <https://www.themalaysianinsight.com/s/244212> and <https://www.themalaysianinsight.com/bahasa/s/244218>
- <https://www.thestar.com.my/business/business-news/2020/05/11/remembering-rastam> (metered)
- <https://www.thestar.com.my/opinion/columnists/wideangle/2008/12/14/a-middle-class-malay-perspective> (former deputy governor of Bank Negara and former MD of Petronas)
- <https://theedgemalaysia.com/article/musical-journey> (Saidah Rastam interview, The Edge Financial Daily, 16 Nov 2015)
- <https://warwick.ac.uk/fac/soc/pais/research/csgr/csgr-events/workshops/2000/transparency/rodan.pdf> (Rodan 2000; quotes Rastam Hadi via Jayasankaran 1999)
- <https://treasure2u.wordpress.com/about-the-pupils-5/> (Malacca High School alumni record)
- <https://dinmerican.wordpress.com/2012/09/01/tunku-aziz-looks-back-at-his-time-in-bank-negara/>

The Full Roster, 1974-2026

Every chairman and every president/CEO, with how each seat changed hands.

The architecture first

PETRONAS was incorporated on 17 August 1974 under the Companies Act 1965, with RM10 million paid-up capital, wholly owned by the Government of Malaysia through the Minister of Finance (Incorporated).

The seat was originally one seat. From 1974 to 1979 the office was "**Chairman and Chief Executive**" — a single combined post. The Petroleum Development Act 1974, s.3(2), puts PETRONAS "subject to the control and direction of the Prime Minister who may from time to time issue such direction as he may deem fit." A 1976 legal analysis of the Act is explicit: "*The power of appointment of the Chairman is not reserved to a meeting of the Board of Directors... but is vested in the Prime Minister.*" PETRONAS Article 109, later cited in court, provides that the Prime Minister appoints the chairman, who exercises the government's proxy in accordance with the Prime Minister's directions.

The two seats separated at some point between 1979 and November 1986 (see the declared gap below) and have been separate ever since — **except for eight years, 2004 to 2012, when the chair was held on an acting basis by the sitting CEO.**

Chairman succession

#	Chairman	Tenure	Seat	Appointed by
1	Tengku Razaleigh Hamzah	1974 – 1976	Chairman & Chief Executive	PM Tun Abdul Razak
2	Tan Sri Abdul Kadir Shamsuddin	1976 – 8 Nov 1978 †	Chairman & Chief Executive	PM (Razak / Hussein Onn)
3	Tun Abdullah Mohd Salleh	1 Jan 1979 – early 1988	Chairman & Chief Executive (chair later split)	PM Tun Hussein Onn
4	Tun Raja Mohar Raja Badiozaman	[GAP] – Feb 1988	Chairman	PM (Hussein Onn / Mahathir)
5	Tan Sri Basir Ismail	1988 – Feb 1995	Chairman	PM Tun Dr Mahathir
6	Tun Azizan Zainul Abidin	Feb 1995 – 14 Jul 2004 †	Chairman (CEO 1988–95)	PM Tun Dr Mahathir
—	<i>vacant / acting (Hassan Marican)</i>	<i>14 Jul 2004 – 10 Feb 2010</i>	<i>acting, held by the CEO</i>	<i>no appointment made</i>
—	<i>vacant / acting (Shamsul Azhar)</i>	<i>10 Feb 2010 – 30 Jun 2012</i>	<i>acting, held by the CEO</i>	<i>no appointment made</i>
7	Tan Sri Mohd Sidek Hassan	1 Jul 2012 – 30 Jun 2018	Chairman	PM Datuk Seri Najib Razak
8	Tan Sri Ahmad Nizam Salleh		Chairman	

#	Chairman	Tenure	Seat	Appointed by
		1 Aug 2018 – 31 Jul 2021		PMO (PM Mahathir Mohamad)
9	Tan Sri Dato' Seri Mohd Bakke Salleh	1 Aug 2021 – present	Chairman (incumbent)	PM Tan Sri Muhyiddin Yassin

President / Group CEO succession

#	President / Group CEO	Tenure	Appointed by
1	Tengku Razaleigh Hamzah	1974 – 1976	PM Tun Abdul Razak
2	Tan Sri Abdul Kadir Shamsuddin †	1976 – 8 Nov 1978	PM
3	Tun Abdullah Mohd Salleh	1 Jan 1979 – early 1988	PM Tun Hussein Onn
4	Tun Azizan Zainul Abidin	Feb 1988 – Feb 1995	PM Tun Dr Mahathir (recommended him)
5	Tan Sri Mohd Hassan Marican	Feb 1995 – 9 Feb 2010	PM Tun Dr Mahathir / Abdullah Badawi
6	Tan Sri Shamsul Azhar Abbas	10 Feb 2010 – 31 Mar 2015	PM Datuk Seri Najib Razak
7	Tan Sri Wan Zulkiflee Wan Ariffin	1 Apr 2015 – 30 Jun 2020	PM Datuk Seri Najib Razak
8	YM Tan Sri Tengku Muhammad Taufik	1 Jul 2020 – present	PM Tan Sri Muhyiddin Yassin

The founding executive directors (1974)

Two men were appointed alongside Razaleigh, and they are the reason the early company had any financial backbone at all:

- **Dato' Rastam Hadi** — then **Deputy Governor of Bank Negara Malaysia**, assigned by Tun Razak to be an executive director. He is the man The Edge credits with the founding discipline: he "taught the pioneers to *fight like bulldogs*" and "drilled into the organisation the necessary management and financial discipline, turning it into one that is cautious about spending and where accountability ranks high." An employee's recorded lament from that era: "*we are a very rich organisation but sometimes, it feels like being an orphan working here.*" Local Malaysian sources date his appointment directly by Tun Razak to the Lembaga Utama as Executive Director to **10 November 1974**.
- **Dato' Wan Ismail Wan Mohd Salleh** — a senior legal officer recruited from the **Attorney General's Chambers**. He supplied the legal and incorporation capacity, which the 1974 company needed immediately in order to contest concession rights with Shell, Esso and Mobil.

Twelve people are recorded as the founding leadership group — the chairman, the two executive directors, and the mixed group of professionals from the private sector and the civil service they recruited.

Gaps in this roster

1. **Raja Mohar's chairmanship start year** — he is documented as Chairman by MEES on 6 November 1986, and as retiring in February 1988. Abdullah Mohd Salleh was appointed "chairman and chief executive" on 1 January 1979. **The handover year is in no located source.**
2. **When the chair was first split from the chief executive role** — evidently between 1979 and Nov 1986. No source names the decision or its author.
3. **Abdul Kadir Shamsuddin's exact appointment date** — only "1976", after his September 1976 civil-service retirement.
4. **Whether the November/December 1976 PSCs were signed under Abdul Kadir or Razaleigh.**
5. **Razaleigh's exact departure month in 1976** — only "1976" and "a two-year stint".
6. **No individual pay figure exists for any chair or CEO, in any year, ever.** PETRONAS publishes only whole-board aggregates (FY2024: RM21m for the entire board).

What the Seat Rewards

Five patterns in how PETRONAS leadership is actually allocated.

Person	Seat	Verdict	The one-line reason
Tengku Razaleigh Hamzah	Chairman & CE 1974-76	LAYAK KUAT	Wrote the Petroleum Development Act and forced the majors to the table
Abdul Kadir Shamsuddin	Chairman & CE 1976-78	LAYAK KUAT	Landed the PSC and stood up Malaysia LNG; died in office
Abdullah Mohd Salleh	Chairman & CE 1979-88	LAYAK BERSYARAT	Built the LNG and refinery base; the "mini-empires" grew on his watch
Raja Mohar Raja Badiozaman	Chairman c.1984-88	LAYAK BERSYARAT	Broke the 1975 PSC deadlock as the PM's adviser; short, thin chairmanship
Basir Ismail	Chairman 1988-95	LAYAK BERSYARAT	Proven institutional repairer, placed by discretion; no oil background
Azizan Zainul Abidin	CEO 1988-95, Chairman 1995-2004	LAYAK KUAT	Built the institution — Shared Values, internal succession, 30% international by 2002
Hassan Marican	CEO 1995-2010	LAYAK KUAT	Fifteen years, RM471.3bn returned to the state, 42.1% of revenue international
Shamsul Azhar Abbas	CEO 2010-15	LAYAK BERSYARAT	Ran the biggest capital programme in the highest-price years; the cycle carried him
Wan Zulkiflee Wan Ariffin	CEO 2015-20	LAYAK KUAT	Cut RM50bn of cost while production rose and PFLNG Satu came onstream
Mohd Sidek Hassan	Chairman 2012-18	LAYAK BERSYARAT	Restored role separation as PETRONAS promised; exit sequenced against an incoming PM
Ahmad Nizam Salleh	Chairman 2018-21	LAYAK KUAT	37 years in the sector; paid RM34bn through the worst year in the company's history
Bakke Salleh	Chairman 2021-	LAYAK BERSYARAT	Largest dividend ever, then cut it 38%; his "independent" label is not stable
Tengku Muhammad Taufik	CEO 2020-	LAYAK BERSYARAT	Sharpest turnaround on record, then three straight years of decline and a dividend cut

Pattern 1 — The seat began as a political hinge, then became an administrative posting

Razaleigh's chairmanship was explicitly equated to Cabinet rank, and The Malaysianist records that it was "the only time that role had executive powers". After he left to become Finance Minister, the next three chairmen came from the same small pool: **the Chief Secretary's office and the Treasury**. The Edge's summary is blunt — "*Since then, Petronas chairmen have been selected from among senior civil servants and professionals.*" No politician has chaired PETRONAS since 1976.

Pattern 2 — The Chairman's seat may be filled for eight years by a CEO who was never given it

From July 2004 to July 2012, nobody was appointed chairman. The office was held *in an acting capacity* by whoever sat in the CEO chair. PETRONAS only described this as a defect when it ended it — the 2012 release restoring "clear demarcation of roles". Eight years, record results, and no separate board anchor above the executive.

Pattern 3 — Oil knowledge was never the qualification, and still is not

Of eleven chairmen, **exactly one — Azizan — came out of PETRONAS's own operating core**, and he entered as a career civil servant. The rest were a prince-politician, four senior civil servants, a corporate turnaround specialist, an accountant-CEO holding the seat by default, and three GLC generalists. Operations competence has consistently sat one tier down, in the President/CEO line. The Edge's phrase for this is the "administrative balance" the civil-service chairs provided against strong operating personalities.

Pattern 4 — The end of a CEO's term is a political event, not a performance verdict

- Hassan Marican: fifteen years, record results, **six days' notice** that his contract would not be renewed.
- Shamsul Azhar: appointed over the incumbent's own succession slate, and noted as the same age as the man he replaced.
- Wan Zulkiflee: the groomed internal candidate, contract allowed to lapse at the change of government in 2020.
- Tengku Muhammad Taufik: **two extensions**, each reported as a matter of what the Prime Minister decides.

The through-line is that the CEO seat is a **renewable political appointment**, and length of tenure measures political tolerance at least as much as it measures delivery.

Pattern 5 — Dividends are the real dial, and they track fiscal need as much as affordability

The declared payment moved from RM30b (FY2010) and RM26b (2015) up to RM50b (2022), RM40b (2023), RM32b (2025), then **RM20b approved for 2026 — the lowest in nine years**. In 2008 alone PETRONAS supplied **45% of federal revenue**; the five-year figure is above 20%; the cumulative contribution since 1974 is put at nearly **RM1.6 trillion**. Every chairman's public record is, in part, a record of how much of that was taken out and how much was left in the ground.

What no one in the record was ever asked to justify

Pay. PETRONAS Group and its listed companies state plainly in their Corporate Governance Reports that they "**opt not to disclose the personal data of their Senior Management personnel to the public at large**", invoking the Personal Data Protection Act 2010. The holding company's audited financial statements disclose only an aggregate for all directors together — RM15m across the whole board in FY2025. So the individual pay of the person running a company that contributes roughly a fifth of the federal budget is not on the public record. That is the largest unresolved governance question in this archive.

The number every dossier keeps returning to

Twenty-two years. Between 1974 and 2012, some form of fused chair-and-CEO power — formally executive until about 1984, then acting-fused from 2004 to 2012 — ran for roughly twenty-two of the company's first thirty-eight years. PETRONAS's own 2012 language is the verdict on that: clear demarcation of roles is a "global standard of good governance". It took the company thirty-eight years to say so about itself.

Sources for this section

PETRONAS Annual Reports and Audited Financial Statements 2009-2025 (petronas.com) · PETRONAS media releases (27 Feb 2026 dividend; FY2022, FY2023, FY2025 results) · The Edge Malaysia (In 761 "Big Money"; "My Say: The Petronas DNA"; "My Say: The Petronas journey continues"; 2 Jul 2012 Sidek appointment; 10-16 Aug 2026) · Reuters (Special Report 2012; 10 Oct 2025) · The Star (30 Aug 2022; 27 Feb 2026) · The Malaysianist ("Petronas: An origins story") · Bernama · PETRONAS Gas Berhad Corporate Governance Reports 2020-2025 — the PDPA 2010 non-disclosure statement appears in each, e.g. petronas.com/pgb/sites/default/files/2026-03/PGB%20Corporate%20Governance%20Report%202025.pdf

Sources & Provenance

Where every claim came from, and what could not be verified.

Every claim in this archive carries an inline source. This page states where the material came from, how it was graded, and — most importantly — what could not be established.

How claims were graded

Each factual line is labelled: **OBS** (observed in a cited source), **INT** (an inference drawn from sourced facts), **SPEC** (speculation, or the source's own motive attribution), **UNK** (not verified). Where sources conflicted, the conflict is printed rather than averaged.

The research rule throughout: **nothing invented to fill a gap**. A thin person gets a thin dossier, and the archive says so.

Primary sources — PETRONAS's own record

- **PETRONAS Integrated Reports and Audited Financial Statements**, FY2009 through FY2025, including the "Commitment to Governance" sections — board composition, director profiles, remuneration policy, independence assessments.
- **PETRONAS media releases** — CEO and chairman appointments and departures; annual and half-year results; the June 2025 rightsizing statement; the 25 May 2026 PRefChem transfer.
- **PETRONAS "Our Leaders"** page, checked 17 September 2026 — the current board and executive leadership team.
- **PETRONAS Gas Berhad Corporate Governance Reports, 2020-2025** — the source for the group's non-disclosure of senior-management remuneration under the Personal Data Protection Act 2010.
- **PETRONAS brand-story page** — founding headcount and early history.

Independent corporate filings

These proved decisive for a period where journalism is silent:

- **Danaharta Annual Report 1999** and **Johan Holdings Annual Report 2000** — both record Raja Mohar Raja Badiozaman as PETRONAS chairman **1984-1988**, which is what resolves the Abdullah Salleh succession puzzle.
- **Sembcorp Marine / Seatrium** and SGX filings — Hassan Marican's post-2010 chairmanship dates.
- **Bursa Malaysia filings** — Sime Darby Plantation, Telekom Malaysia, Malaysia Airports, Imaspro — for the post-PETRONAS corporate careers.

Press and wire

The Edge Malaysia (including "Big Money: If it ain't broke, don't fix it", "My Say: The Petronas DNA", "My Say: The Petronas journey continues", "Who is Taufik, the new chieftain of Petronas") ·

The Star · New Straits Times · Bernama · Malay Mail · Free Malaysia Today · Malaysiakini · Harian Metro · mStar · Astro Awani · Focus Malaysia · The Malaysianist · Nikkei Asia · Singapore's Business Times and Straits Times via NewspaperSG · Reuters · Bloomberg · The Guardian · Upstream Online · S&P Global.

Archival and academic

- **Perdana Leadership Foundation news library** (lib.perdana.org.my) — Mahathir-era press files, obituaries, and the Che Det columns.
- **Arkib Negara** (pustakailmu.arkib.gov.my) — Tun Abdullah Mohd Salleh's official biography.
- **Universiti Sains Malaysia** — *Kajian Malaysia* 38(2) 2020, the peer-reviewed article on Abdul Kadir Shamsuddin.
- **Kamarudin & A. Rahman, SEJARAH 2019** (DOI 10.22452/sejarah.vol28no2.8) — the peer-reviewed account of Basir Ismail's appointment and the privatisation network.
- **MAJECA 40th anniversary book** and **Wikipedia (English and Bahasa Melayu)** — used for dates and honours, and cross-checked against contemporaneous sources wherever a date mattered.
- **Malaysian Petroleum Club official history** — the CEO succession and the club's founding by Azizan Zainul Abidin.

Honest gaps — what this archive could NOT establish

1. **Wan Ismail Wan Mohd Salleh.** One authoritative sentence exists (The Edge, 2010) plus a 2015 PETRONAS Alumni patron listing and a low-authority genealogy entry with conflicting dates. **His birth and death dates, portfolio and later career are UNK.** Nothing was invented to fill the space.
2. **Raja Mohar's exact appointment date in 1984** and the appointing instrument. Bounded by corporate filings and press, not by a board minute.
3. **The exact day in 1976 that Abdul Kadir Shamsuddin took the PETRONAS chair,** and whether he personally signed the PSC documents. **UNK.**
4. **The exact date of the chairman/president split** (1983-84). Bounded by press reporting, not found in a minute.
5. **Remuneration.** PETRONAS Group and its listed companies formally opt out of disclosing senior-management pay under the PDPA 2010. Only board aggregates appear. **No individual chairman's or CEO's pay is on the public record.**
6. **The reason for Hassan Marican's non-renewal in 2010** — institutional or personal. Only reporter sourcing exists; no first-party account.
7. **The exact term of Tengku Muhammad Taufik's August 2026 extension** — reported at two to three years, disputed, PETRONAS declining comment.
8. **The independence-assessment reasoning** behind Mohd Bakke Salleh's label changing twice in PETRONAS's own reports.

9. **"OD1 March 2027"** — this milestone does not appear in any source located. The published rightsizing schedule completes the new organisation design by 1 August 2026.
10. **The "RM22 billion PRefChem accumulated losses"** figure — unverified. The figure that IS on the record is RM14.8 billion of previously unrecognised accumulated joint-venture losses recognised in 1H2026.

Sources deliberately rejected

- **Grokipedia** on Razaleigh's chairmanship — claims he chaired until 1980, contradicted by the contemporaneous record that Abdul Kadir Shamsuddin chaired from 1976 and died in office in November 1978. **Rejected.**
- **Geni genealogy entries** — user-generated; used only as a flagged low-authority snippet, never as a fact base.
- **Undated Bernama photo captions** — Basir Ismail's MAS chairmanship rests on one undated caption. Carried as **PARTIALLY VERIFIED**, with dates UNK.

The dignity rule applied in this archive

Every person here is treated as a public office-holder whose **decisions and outcomes** are open to assessment, and whose **private life is not**. No health, family, financial or personal matter is asserted anywhere in this document. Verdicts are about fitness for a seat, judged on the record — not about the worth of a person.

Where a subject's conduct is described, it is sourced to a named outlet with a date, and the strongest counter-argument is printed beside it.

Compiled 17 September 2026. Prepared for Arif Fazil.

Source conflicts are printed, not smoothed. Unverified items are labelled, not filled.